

PAUSAL FORMS IN BIBLICAL HEBREW: THEIR FUNCTION, ORIGIN AND SIGNIFICANCE*

E. J. REVELL

UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO

I. INTRODUCTION

Pausal forms are generally (probably universally) held to be conditioned by phonological features similar to the intonation patterns which mark the ends of sentences in English. If this is so, they ought to occur regularly, according to predictable patterns. Their distribution is usually described in terms of the accent system. It is true that as a general rule pausal forms occur with *silluq*, *atnah*, and *'oleh we-yored*. In fact a considerable proportion of pausal forms (over 25% in some books) occurs with other accents (even conjunctive accents), and there is a small but significant number of cases in which pausal forms are not used with major pausal accents. The accent system cannot, then, either be the conditioning factor, or reflect it.¹

2. THE FUNCTION OF PAUSAL FORMS IN PROSE TEXTS

2.1. The Book of Deuteronomy provides excellent illustrations of the positions in which pausal forms occur in biblical prose. About 465 pausal forms occur in this book. Less than 76% of these occur with *atnah* or *silluq*. The remaining 24% of the pausal

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¹ Note also that the same vowel and accent signs are used in the Aramaic of the Bible as in the Hebrew, but pausal forms occur in only a few of the cases where they would in Hebrew. Pause is a feature of the language, not a product of the biblical chant.

forms mostly occur with *segolta*, *zaqef*, or *tifha*; however, 9 occur with *revia*, 5 with *pashta*, 3 with *telisha*, and one with each of *zarqa*, *tevir*, *geresh*, and the conjunctive *munah*. Thus 21 pausal forms, or nearly 5%, occur with accents of distinctly minor pausal value.

2.2. About 75% of the pausal forms occur at the ends of clauses. Those which occur within clauses can be grouped in two basic categories: those marking the ends of equivalent units used in parallel function, and those which simply divide a clause into two parts. Equivalent units in parallel function can range from a long series of nouns in a list, to two or three prepositional phrases. In such cases a pausal form is not used after every item unless the items are unusually long or significant. As far as can be determined, the usual practice is to group the items in twos or threes, and use a pausal form at the end of each group. Examples are: for a list, Deut. v. 14 (cf. vii. 13 etc.)

לא תעשה כל מלאכה אתה ובנך ובתך ועבדך זאמֶתָךְ

ושורך וחמרך וכל בהמֶתָךְ ...

and for parallel phrases Deut. xxviii. 67 (cf. xxii. 9, xxxiii. 13 etc.)

בבקר תאמר ... ובערב תאמר ... מפחד לבבך אשר תפחֶדךָ

וממראה עיניך אשר תראה:

It is noteworthy that the items in lists are often grouped in a similar way by the accents, as in Deut. viii. 8 and also by verse divisions, as in Neh. xii. 1 ff. (separating items in a list) or in Deut. ix. 1 f. (separating parallel phrases).

2.3. Where pausal forms are used between phrases which are not syntactically equivalent, they seem generally to occur at the end of the most significant part or "core" of the clause, and to divide it from less important phrases, often explanatory modifiers, which follow.¹ The purpose would seem to be to emphasise the basic statement in the core of the clause. Examples are: Deut. xiii. 18

ורחמֶתְךָ והרֶבֶךָ כאשר נשבע לאבתֶיךָ:

where the pausal form is followed by an explanatory modifier (cf. xxv. 13, xxviii. 27 etc.), and Deut. v. 27

קרב אתה ושִׁמְעֵךְ את כל אשר יאמר יהוה אלהיֶינוּ

¹ Cf. the similar phenomena in the accentuation called "Supplemental clause" and "Zusatz" in W. Wickes, *A treatise on the accentuation of the twenty-one... books*, Oxford 1887, 32, 45, 47, 48, 57, cf. 3 on pp. 53-4.

where the pausal form separates a verb from its object to emphasise the command (cf. also Deut. viii. 16, etc.). Again the same sort of division is frequently marked by the accents, or by verse divisions, as in Deut. iv. 47-8 (cf. iv. 41-2, etc.).

2.4. Pausal forms are not generally used at the ends of clauses introducing speech.¹ Similarly pausal forms are not generally used before relative clauses introduced by 'šr. There are about 110 other cases in Deuteronomy in which a clause ends in a contextual form. Such clauses are usually closely related to the following clause, and they are usually short, often only a verb form, as in Deut. xiii. 18, v. 27 quoted above (2.3). Deut. xiv. 25 provides a longer example (with no pause at *bydk*), and Deut. iv. 19 an exceptionally long one

וּפֶן תִּשָּׂא ... הַשְׁמִימָה זָרְאִית ... הַשְׁמִים וְנִדְחָתָהּ. וְהַשְׁתַּחֲוִיתָּ , וְעַבַּדְתָּם

It is in this area, where two or more clauses are joined into one unit, that the semantic element governing the use of pausal forms is most apparent. The perception of a semantic relationship of this sort is, of course, a matter of individual interpretation. However, there is never serious difficulty in accepting clauses joined this way as a semantic unit, even though it might, in some cases, seem more natural to separate them.²

2.5. Pausal forms are used in the same ways in the other prose materials of the Hebrew Bible.³ The details of their use differ, of course, from book to book, but all show the same general pattern. Pausal forms mark the ends of clauses, or of "sentences", i.e. semantic units formed of two or more clauses. Rarely they occur within clauses, again marking a division made on a

¹ Thus forms from the root 'mr in Gen. xxxiv. 31 and Deut. xxi. 7 both show contextual forms with *atnah*. Pausal forms do, however, occur in this position, as in Deut. viii. 17, xviii. 21 (but cf. vii. 17); and xviii. 17 (but cf. i. 42 etc.). The accentuation likewise rarely marks a major pause after an introduction to speech (see Wickes, *Twenty-one books*, pp. 35 f.), although this may occur (e.g. Gen. xxiii. 5, 10, 14, also 8, but cf. 13).

² E.g. in Deut. ii. 28 it would seem natural to treat the clause-groups ending "I will eat" and "I will drink" as contrasting, and separate them, but there is no pause at *w'kelty*, showing that they were considered as different aspects of the same idea, and so treated as a unit (cf. Deut. ix. 9, 18).

³ In Psalms, Proverbs and Job, the use of pausal forms appears to be determined by poetic structure. The stylistic/semantic unit, the stich, usually ends with a pausal form where these are distinguished (see 7.3 below). In the poetical passages in the *Twenty-one books* (e.g. in the Latter Prophets) this does not seem to be the general rule, and the use of the pausal forms seems to be governed by principles close to those visible in the prose passages.

semantic basis. The proportion of cases in which the presence or absence of a pausal form occasions surprise is too small (no more than 2% or 3%) to disrupt the general regularity of this pattern. In other words the pausal forms act as punctuation, reflecting a logical system of text division.¹

2.6. As the above examples show, this system of division appears to follow the same principles as that represented by the accents, and the two systems very often coincide. Thus words with *silluq* and (outside the poetical books) *atnah* almost always show pausal vowelling (if they distinguish it). However, if it is agreed that the pausal forms reflect a logical system of text division, it is necessary to conclude either that the accents reflect a different way of grouping the words of the text into semantic units, or that they do not have this function at all. The pausal forms show clearly that the 1st in Deut. v. 14 (see 2.2 above) was read in groups of two or three items. In some cases the accent system agrees with the pausal forms in dividing the text in this way, as in Lev. xiv. 54-6.

זאת החורה לכל נע הצרעת ולנתק:

ולצרעת הבגד ולבית:

ולשאת ולספחת ולבהרת:

The fact that no such agreement between pausal forms and verse division occurs in Deut. v. 14 must mean that if the accents reflect a way of reading the text, that way was, in this verse, different from that reflected by the pausal forms. Similarly the information on the use of pausal forms in Ezekiel xvi, xvii, and xviii given below (see 7.5) must show either that the pausal forms and the accents reflect different ways of grouping the words of the text into semantic units, or that the accent system does not reflect such a grouping.² There is no reason to accept the latter

¹ Consistency in stressing an idea is shown by the pausal punctuation in Lev. viii. 15, 19 and 23 (*wyshat*), and in 1 Sam. viii. 11, 13, 14, 16 (*yqlh*). It must be remembered, however, that both the pausal and accentual punctuation reflect an understanding of the whole context, so that the same or similar wording is not always treated in the same way.

² On this function of the accents, see note 1, p. 169. Because the accents represent musical phenomena, not pauses, it is difficult to make a definite statement about their pausal value. In other forms of chant, however, particular musical motifs regularly represent the end of semantic units, and this is generally understood to be the case in the Biblical chant. (See such analyses as those of Levin in *JBL* LXXXVII (1968), 64-7, Freedman and Cohen in *Masoretic Studies* 1, 35.) It is commonly said that the pausal value of the biblical accents

alternative.¹ Consequently, it is concluded here that the pausal forms in biblical prose reflect a system of text division which is independent of, and somewhat different from, that reflected by the accents.

2.7. The Masoretic text, then, contains evidence of two different systems of text division, one based on the verse divisions, and marked by the accent signs, and the other marked by the pausal forms through the vowel signs and stress position.² It seems probable that the accent system, which is still the basis for the public recitation of the text, superseded the pausal system, which was at that time already fixed in the traditional pronunciation.³ There is, however, no evidence to show conclusively that one system is earlier than the other. The system of accent signs perfected by the Tiberian masoretes was certainly based on a long tradition,⁴ but it is clear that the pausal system of punctuation also has ancient roots.

depends on the context in which they are used, but if this is the case, i.e. if *zaqef* (for instance) may or may not mark the end of a semantic unit, then the accentuation cannot have a semantic basis, but only a musical one. In my opinion the correct statement is not that the pausal value of the accents is variable, but that the division of the text which seemed logical when the present accent system was established in it, no longer always seems logical to us today. (Cf., for instance, Jud. vi. 24, where the accentuation makes *yhw* the subject of *wyqr*, against all the commentators.)

¹ The value of the accentuation as marking text divisions is noted in the tenth century *Hidāyat al-qārī* (see Ginsberg, *The Massorah* III, p. 50, col. 1). Indeed, the Talmudic phrase *pisuq te'amim* may well reflect recognition of this function (see E. Werner, *The sacred bridge*, New York 1959, 111).

² There is other evidence that vowel patterns are independent of accentuation (though usually consistent with it), e.g. the exceptions to the standard rule that (in certain words) *segol* or (short) *qameṣ* occurs before *maqṣef*, but *šere* or *ḥolem* with an accent. Cf. *bn* in Gen. xxx. 19 and Lev. xxiv. 10; *rb* in Isa. i. 11, *kl* in Ps. xxxv. 10 etc.

³ The value of the accents as marking text divisions has long been recognised (note 1), but the function of the pausal forms (i.e. of those which occur with accents other than *atnaḥ* and *silluq*) has never been clearly described.

⁴ Verse division is generally stable in Jewish MSS of all traditions (but the Samaritan accentuation does not always agree). Major differences from BHS in divisions within the verse are rare in Tiberian or Palestinian MSS, more common in Babylonian. There is evidence to suggest that the Tiberian tradition of text division in the Torah may go back to the second century B.C. (Revell, *BJRL* LIV (1971), 219).

3. THE ORIGIN OF PAUSAL FORMS:

EVIDENCE FROM PHONOLOGY

It is generally agreed that pausal forms reflect the vowel patterns of a stage of the Hebrew Language somewhat earlier than that represented by the received vocalisation. That is, they arose at some period prior to that of the masoretes.¹ It is also true, although this has not been noted, that the conditions which created the difference between pausal and contextual forms had ceased to operate by the time the received vocalisation was established. In various forms showing *pataḥ* or *segol* in the stress syllable *qameṣ* appears in pausal position where the original vowel was "a" but, where it was "i", the *pataḥ* or *segol* is usually retained in pause.² If the two vowels had been the same when the pausal forms were developed, they would have changed in the same way. The fact that *pataḥ* or *segol* deriving from original "i" is not usually replaced by *qameṣ* in pause, shows that the creation of new pausal forms had ceased before the time when the reflex of original "i" in these forms became identical to that of original "a", that is, before the period represented by any of the three vocalisation systems.³ A similar conclusion can be drawn from the fact that the few contextual forms which occur with *atnaḥ* and *silluq*, and the few pausal forms which occur with conjunctive accents (no doubt also the larger number which occur with minor disjunctives) also remain unchanged.⁴ It is clear, then, that the pausal forms were already fixed in the reading tradition when its received form was established by the masoretes. Consequently, their position in the text, and so the system of text division which they represent, must date from some earlier period.

¹ If the reconstruction in J. Blau, *A grammar of biblical Hebrew* (Wiesbaden, 1976), §9.1 is followed, this would have occurred in the fourth stress period, while the Tiberian vocalisation represents the fifth.

² This may be seen in forms such as *bat*, *gat*, *qmal*, *ṣṣqanti* (Isa. xxxiii. 9, Gen. xviii. 13 etc.), *dibbarti*, *šibbarti*, *hiṣṣalti*, *leqah*, *neder*, etc. *Qameṣ* reflecting original "i" occurs only sporadically in such forms.

³ The reflex of original "i" where MT has *pataḥ* was still different from that of "a" at the time of Origen, see E. Brønno, *Studien über hebräische Morphologie und Vokalismus*, Leipzig 1943, 448.

⁴ The variants in C. D. Ginsburg's *The Old Testament...with the various readings*, London 1926, quite often show *qameṣ* where BHS has *pataḥ* with *atnaḥ* in the poetical books, but this affects only these two vowels, not other types of contextual and pausal forms, and so it probably represents hyper-correction based on the rule of thumb that *qameṣ* was normal with *atnaḥ* and *silluq*, *pataḥ* with other accents.

4. THE ORIGIN OF PAUSAL FORMS:

EVIDENCE FROM BIBLICAL LITERATURE

4.1. The majority of pausal forms occur at the ends of clauses, where a stop might be expected in any linguistic tradition. The cases where pausal forms are used within clauses frequently do not coincide with the conventions of other languages, so that if another tradition does use stops in a similar way, the two are likely to be related. Two cases are particularly striking. (1) A pausal form is not usually used at the end of an introduction to speech, which conflicts with the Greek and Latin convention.¹ (2) Lists are usually divided into groups of two or three items. This contrasts with the accentuation of the Mishna, where a pause is usually marked after every item in a list, agreeing (whether through coincidence or influence) with the Greek convention.²

4.2. In many cases the pausal forms within a clause appear to be used for emphasis. They either draw attention to what precedes, before some modifier is added, or they separate the parts of a syntactic unit (such as the verb and its object) and so cause suspense, and emphasise what follows (see 2.3). Interjections may perform a similar function. The phrase *n'm ybwh* is usually used at the end of a clause, but quite often occurs as an interjection within a clause. In these cases it often occurs in positions similar to those in which pausal forms are used within clauses, and may plausibly be interpreted as having a similar function.

4.3. The situation in which *n'm ybwh* appears within clauses can be grouped as follows:

4.3.1. *n'm ybwh* may be used after an "adverbial introduction"

¹ For the use of pausal forms and accents in the Hebrew text in this situation see p. 167 note 1. A stop is usually marked after an introduction to speech in Byzantine chant (see *Studies in Eastern Chant* I (1966), 41). That the same was true in earlier times can readily be seen from the Vulgate (the new Benedictine edition, Rome 1966-, attempts to present Jerome's original *cola et commata*) and from punctuated Greek MSS such as Alexandrinus.

² For the situation in Mishna MSS see I. Yeivin in *Lešonenu* xxiv (1959-60), 209, also my forthcoming article in *Studies in Eastern Chant* IV, para. 1.b(i) of the section "Accentuation of Rabbinic texts", and examples 1: 3, 3: 2, 4: 2, 6. In Codex Alexandrinus items in a list are frequently separated by a space (with a dot in it) as in Exod. i. 2-4, Lev. xiv. 54-6. This is presumably the usage described by Hermogenes Rhetor as "*to kat' onoma kommatikon*" (*Opera*, ed. H. Rabe = *Rhetores graeci* VI, Leipzig 1913, 316).

but before the "core" of the clause in which the main idea is expressed. The adverbial introduction consists of one or two prepositional phrases, or of an adverb (often *'th*), and is usually concerned with time, as in 1 Sam. ii. 30, Isa. xxii. 25, Jer. v. 18, viii. 1, xxi. 7, xxxi. 1, l. 4, 20, Joel ii. 12, Mic. iv. 6, Hag. ii. 23, Zech. iii. 10, xii. 4. The adverbial introduction may also be concerned with space, as in Ezek. xx. 40, or with manner, as in Jer. l. 40.

כמהפכת אלהים את סדם ... נאם יהוה לא ישב שם איש

In a similar way *n'm yhwsh* is used after *lkn* introducing a consequence in 1 Sam. ii. 30 and in Isa. i. 24. Group I is the most common situation in which *n'm yhwsh* is used within clauses. Parallels in the use of pausal forms are not common.¹ See, however, Num. xi. 9 and Esth. i. 10 for the use of pausal forms after an introductory phrase referring to time, and Num. xxxv. 8 for the use of one after a phrase expressing manner:

איש כפי נחלתו אשר ינחלו יתן מערייו ללויים:

One can also compare the use of pausal forms after invocations in 1 Kings xvii. 20, 21, complex subjects in Num. xviii. 1, 1, xix. 16, and "casus pendens" in Num. xxx. 14, 1 Kings v. 19, etc.

4.3.2. *n'm yhwsh* used after the "core" of the clause, which expresses the main idea, but before some "explanatory modifiers".² Such explanatory modifiers may modify the verb of the clause, as in Jer. xiii. 11, xvii. 24, xxv. 7, Ezek. xxxvi. 23, cf. the pausal form in Num. xxii. 18. The phrase may similarly modify the "headword" of the predicate of a non-verbal clause, as the infinitive phrase in Jer. i. 19

כי אתך אני נאם יהוה להצילך:

(So also Jer. xxx. 11, xlix. 5, Ezek. xliii. 19.) Cf. the pausal form in 2 Sam. iii. 12

והנה ידי עמך להסב אליך את כל ישראל:

Phrases following *n'm yhwsh* may also modify other parts of the preceding core of the clause. In this case they typically expand an

¹ It is also, of course, true that *'th* does not appear in pausal form in parallel cases where *n'm yhwsh* is not used, although it often does have a relatively strong pausal accent, as in Gen. iv. 11, xii. 19, xx. 7. This use of *n'm yhwsh* does, however, correspond to usage typical of the accent system, see Wickes, *Twenty-one books*, p. 47.

² The accents often divide clauses in a similar way, see p. 166, note 1.

idea given in the core of the clause.¹ In Jer. l. 35 and Zeph. iii. 8 this occurs in a prepositional phrase, cf. the pausal form in Isa. xiv. 15 or Deut. xxx. 9. In Jer. xv. 3 a noun phrase is expanded in this way.

ופקדתי עליהם ארבע משפחות נאם יהוה את החרב להרג ואת ...

(so also Jer. xvi. 5, xxix. 11), cf. the pausal form in 1 Kings iii. 13

וגם אשר לא שאלת נתתי לך גם עשר גם כבוד

The element expanded may even be the pronominal morph in the verb form, as in Amos iii. 10 (cf. the pausal form in Lev. xxv. 41), and similar usage occurs in non-verbal clauses, as Isa. xxx. 1, Jer. xxi. 13, xxiii. 30, 31, li. 25, Ezek. xvi. 30 (cf. the pausal form in 2 Sam. xii. 1). In some cases the phrases following *n'm whb* express an addition to some item in the core of the clause rather than an expansion of it; that is, *n'm whb* stands between equivalent units in parallel syntactic function (see 2.2 above). This occurs in a verbal clause in Jer. xix. 12

כן אעשה למקום הזה נאם יהוה וליושביו

Cf. the pausal form in Deut. xxviii. 67 quoted in 2.2 above. There is a similar situation in a non-verbal clause in Isa. xliii. 10 (cf. the pausal form in Gen. xxix. 19).

4.3.3. *n'm whb* may occur within the "core" of the clause; that is, in cases where the basic idea of the clause is not intelligible (as it is in 4.3.1 and 4.3.2) without the phrases which either precede or follow *n'm whb*. For instance, *n'm whb* occurs between the verb and its object in Jer. xlviii. 35

והשבתי למואב נאם יהוה מעלה במה ומקטיר לאלהיו:

Also Jer. xlviii. 30, and compare the pausal form in Deut. v. 27 (2.3 above), also Isa. lxiv. 3. It occurs in various other positions within verbal clauses in Jer. xxxiv. 17, Zeph. i. 10, Zech. ii. 9. Similarly it occurs before the object of a participle in a non-verbal clause in Amos vi. 14

כי הנני מקים עליכם בית ישראל נאם יהוה אלהי הצבאות גוי

This isolation of a single word at the end of a clause has a striking

¹ The accents divide clauses in a similar way in Gen. xxiv. 24, and in several examples listed by Wickes, *Twenty-one books*, on p. 40 under vi.

but before the "core" of the clause in which the main idea is expressed. The adverbial introduction consists of one or two prepositional phrases, or of an adverb (often *'th*), and is usually concerned with time, as in 1 Sam. ii. 30, Isa. xxii. 25, Jer. v. 18, viii. 1, xxi. 7, xxxi. 1, l. 4, 20, Joel ii. 12, Mic. iv. 6, Hag. ii. 23, Zech. iii. 10, xii. 4. The adverbial introduction may also be concerned with space, as in Ezek. xx. 40, or with manner, as in Jer. l. 40.

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idea given in the core of the clause.¹ In Jer. l. 35 and Zeph. iii. 8 this occurs in a prepositional phrase, cf. the pausal form in Isa. xiv. 15 or Deut. xxx. 9. In Jer. xv. 3 a noun phrase is expanded in this way.

וּפְקַדְתִּי עֲלֵיהֶם אַרְבַּע מִשְׁפָּחוֹת נָאִם יְהוָה אֶת הַחֶרֶב לְהִרְגֹּם וְאֵת ...

(so also Jer. xvi. 5, xxix. 11), cf. the pausal form in 1 Kings iii. 13

וְגַם אֲשֶׁר לֹא שָׁאֵלָת נִתְּתִי לָךְ גַּם עֶשֶׂר גַּם כְּבוֹד

The element expanded may even be the pronominal morph in the verb form, as in Amos iii. 10 (cf. the pausal form in Lev. xxv. 41), and similar usage occurs in non-verbal clauses, as Isa. xxx. 1, Jer. xxi. 13, xxiii. 30, 31, li. 25, Ezek. xvi. 30 (cf. the pausal form in 2 Sam. xii. 1). In some cases the phrases following *n'm ywhb* express an addition to some item in the core of the clause rather than an expansion of it; that is, *n'm ywhb* stands between equivalent units in parallel syntactic function (see 2.2 above). This occurs in a verbal clause in Jer. xix. 12

כֵּן אֶעֱשֶׂה לַמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה נָאִם יְהוָה וּלְיוֹשְׁבָיו

Cf. the pausal form in Deut. xxviii. 67 quoted in 2.2 above. There is a similar situation in a non-verbal clause in Isa. xliii. 10 (cf. the pausal form in Gen. xxix. 19).

4.3.3. *n'm ywhb* may occur within the "core" of the clause; that is, in cases where the basic idea of the clause is not intelligible (as it is in 4.3.1 and 4.3.2) without the phrases which either precede or follow *n'm ywhb*. For instance, *n'm ywhb* occurs between the verb and its object in Jer. xlviii. 35

וְהִשְׁבַּתִּי לְמוֹאָב נָאִם יְהוָה מַעֲלָה בְמָה וּמִקְטִיר לְאַלְהֵיוֹ:

Also Jer. xlviii. 30, and compare the pausal form in Deut. v. 27 (2.3 above), also Isa. lxiv. 3. It occurs in various other positions within verbal clauses in Jer. xxxiv. 17, Zeph. i. 10, Zech. ii. 9. Similarly it occurs before the object of a participle in a non-verbal clause in Amos vi. 14

כִּי הִנְנִי מְקִיִּים עֲלֵיכֶם בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל נָאִם יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי הַצְבָּאוֹת יְגִי

This isolation of a single word at the end of a clause has a striking

¹ The accents divide clauses in a similar way in Gen. xxiv. 24, and in several examples listed by Wickes, *Twenty-one books*, on p. 40 under vi.

parallel in the use of the pausal form in Jer. xiii. 13 (also Jer. viii. 1).

כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה הֲנִי מְמַלֵּא אֶת כָּל יֹשְׁבֵי הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת וְאֵת...

וְאֵת ... וְאֵת כָּל יֹשְׁבֵי יְרוּשָׁלַם שְׁכֻרָן:

4.4. Clauses are similarly interrupted by other word groups – most obviously *'mr whb* which appears, at least in some cases, to function as a free variant of *n'm whb* (e.g. Hag. ii. 9, and cf. Jer. xlix. 18 with Jer. l. 40). *'mr whb* is used after an adverbial introduction (cf. group I of *n'm whb*) in Isa. xlix. 5, and Jer. xlix. 18. It stands before an explanatory modifier in Isa. lix. 21 (cf. group II) and in the same verse it stands after the title to a list

וְאֵת זֹאת בְּרִיתִי אִתָּם אָמַר יְהוָה רוּחִי ... וְדִבְרֵי...

Cf. 4.3.2 above, and the pausal form in Deut. xiv. 4

= וְזֶאת הַבְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר תֹּאכְלֶנָּה שׁוֹר שֶׁה כְּשִׁבִים וְשֶׁה עֲוִים:

Finally, *'mr whb* is used between the parts of a non-verbal clause (cf. 4.3.3), in Isa. xlviii. 22 (cf. lvii. 21), as is another interjection, *ly 'mr*, in Isa. xlv. 24

אֲךְ בִּיהוּה לִי אִמֶּךָ צְדָקוֹת וְעֹז

Cf. 4.3.3 above, and the pausal form in Isa. xxiv. 17 (also Jer. xlviii. 43)

פָּחַד וּפַחַת וּפָחַ עֲלֶיךָ יוֹשֵׁב הָאָרֶץ:

(or, in a prose context, Num. iii. 34).

4.5. In groups 4.3.2 and 4.3.3, then, the similarity of the positions in which *n'm whb* and similar interjections are used to those in which the pausal forms are used is very striking. This seems clear evidence that the authors of these passages found it logical to break their clauses in the same positions as did the readers who produced the pausal forms. The interjections are represented in translations, and their positions have become familiar. However, the punctuation of translations (ancient or modern) offers no support for the idea that the parallel uses of the pausal forms represent any natural or universal logic. It is, therefore, reasonable to suggest an organic connection between

the system of punctuation represented by the pausal forms, and the conventions of clause division represented by the interjections in the passages cited.¹

5. THE ORIGIN OF PAUSAL FORMS:

EVIDENCE FROM THE STELE OF MESHA

5.1. The use of the punctuation mark in the inscription of Mesha is also of interest here. This mark is usually placed at the end of a clause, marking off single clauses or (more commonly) groups of two or more clauses.² As with the pausal punctuation, a division is not marked after an introduction to speech (ll. 6, 14, 24-5), nor before a relative clause (ll. 28-9), nor usually before explanatory clauses introduced by *ky* (ll. 3-4, 5, 27), although as in the pausal system, exceptions may occur (l. 17). In three cases the mark is used within a clause, and in two of these it separates items in a list:

ll. 15-17 /w'ḥzḥ w'brg kl[h] šb't 'lpn g[b]rn w[gr]n/wgbrt w[gr]t
wrḥmt/

ll. 29-30 /w'nk bnty[]b' wbt dbltn/wbt b'lm'n...

(Cf. the pausal form in 1 Kings ix. 17, and 2.2 above). In the third case the punctuation mark appears to stand before what has been called above an "explanatory modifier", but the context is broken and the restoration uncertain: ll. 3-4 /w's'š hbm̄t
z't lkm̄š bqrḥb/bm̄[t y]š' ky hš'ny... (cf. the pausal form in 1 Kings v. 31, Gen. xxxi. 18, etc.).

5.2. These marks in the Mesha inscription certainly represent a logical system of punctuation, although some anomalies

¹ It may be questioned, in many cases, whether *n'm yḥwb* formed part of the original material, or was inserted during subsequent development of it. According to Rendtorff (ZAW LXVI (1954), 27-37) and Baumgärtel (ZAW LXXIII (1961), 277-90) most of the examples listed above in 4.3.1 are characteristic of the original usage, as are some in 4.3.2 and 4.3.3 (where, however, some of the cases in books other than Jeremiah would fit Rendtorff's criterion of "Parallelism or equivalent" (pp. 29-30) and so increase the number in this class. E.g. Isa. xliii. 10, Zech. ii. 9). These cases are sufficient to establish that the use of pausal forms within clauses is parallel to the use made of this interjection in the living biblical language, whether the other cases were subsequent imitations or no.

² See the study of F. I. Andersen in "Moabite syntax" (*Orientalia* N.S. xxxv (1966), 85-8). The reference numbers refer to the lines of the original text. The diagonal stroke in the transcription represents the punctuation mark.

suggest that there may be errors in their use.¹ The significance of a Moabite inscription for Biblical Hebrew may also be questioned. However, the language and thought-world represented seem close enough to those of the Book of Kings to warrant the use of the inscription in the present context. Consequently, it seems justifiable to claim that the punctuation of this inscription provides some support for the idea that the pausal forms of the Hebrew Bible reflect patterns of formation of speech units characteristic of the language of the Biblical period.

6. THE FUNCTION AND ORIGIN OF PAUSAL FORMS: CONCLUSIONS

6.1. Pausal forms in the received text appear (with rare exceptions) in positions easily acceptable as the ends of sense units, that is, at a division in the text which is either logical, or serves some special purpose, such as emphasis. The units so terminated consist of a clause, or a group of clauses or (less commonly), part of a clause. The system of text division represented by these pausal forms, that is the system of grouping phrases and clauses into sense units, appears to follow conventions similar (in some cases) to those which can be seen in the language of the prophets (as it has come down to us), and possibly even in the punctuation of the Mesha inscription. It is scarcely probable that this similarity in the logic behind the division of texts shown in these different sources reflects any academic theory of punctuation, such as arose from the Greek schools of rhetoric and textual criticism. It seems virtually certain that in all these cases the basis of the text division was the natural patterns of the language, the division of speech into sense units delimited by intonation patterns. Such intonation patterns, an integral part of the sound system

¹ The main problem is in lines 7-8 where the two clauses /*wyr*ʔl 'bd 'bd 'lm *wyr*ʔ 'mry 't 'r]ʃ mddb' are marked as a single unit, whereas the content appears to require a major break between them. The passage could be understood "(He threatened this in my days, but I triumphed over him and his dynasty.) And Israel suffered a permanent setback, despite Omri's seizure of MHDB'. (Israel occupied it for forty years, but KMŠ restored it in my day.)" It is questionable whether the translation of *wyr*ʔ as "although he had taken possession of" can be justified, but a translation which ignores the punctuation without comment (as all that I know do) is equally unsatisfactory. A lesser problem is the fact that in two of the cases where a stop is marked within a clause, none is marked at its end, but cf. the biblical verse division in cases like Lev. xiv. 57, Neh. xii. 7.

of the language, would naturally have been used in the oratory of the prophets, or in the reading of texts. These intonation patterns evidently became a fixed part of the biblical reading tradition, and so affected its vowel patterns, producing the pausal forms.

6.2. After this fixation had occurred the pausal forms died out of living usage, so that new pausal forms were not created where suitable vowel patterns came into being, or where a different division of the text left a contextual form at the end of a unit. The intonation patterns which gave rise to the pausal forms were evidently transmuted into, or replaced by, the musical patterns of the chant, which thus took over the function of defining the boundaries of (and divisions within) semantic units. As a result the distinction between pausal and contextual vowelling lost its function, becoming simply one of a number of types of such functionless variations preserved in the reading tradition. The masoretic lists of cases where *qameṣ* occurs with *zaqef*, or *paṭaḥ* with *atnaḥ* or *silluq*, show that the relation between the pausal forms and the accents was recognised, but the incompleteness of these lists suggests that the recognition was late. Whether this is so or not, the masoretic tradition did preserve the pausal forms faithfully even in these apparently anomalous cases, and the fact that the patterns which gave rise to them can still be recognised constitutes an important testimony to the antiquity and reliability of the masoretic tradition.

7. IMPLICATIONS FOR THE STUDY OF BIBLICAL LITERATURE

7.1. The assumption that the pausal forms of the Bible (or some of them) reflect a method of reading customary at some time before that of the Masoretes has no doubt been made by many others,¹ and certainly the phenomenon of pause in Arabic would support it. It is, however, of value to have such assumptions confirmed by a detailed investigation, and this investigation has the merit of revealing the high probability of direct connection between the method of reading reflected by the pausal forms and the patterns of speech or oratory of the biblical period. This does not, of course, imply that the method of reading

¹ Cf. the suggestion in G. Bergsträsser, *Hebräische Grammatik*, Leipzig 1918, I, 29a.

reflected by the pausal forms persisted unchanged from ancient times,¹ but it does mean that it reflects ancient patterns of logic and expression.

7.2. The significance of the conclusion that the pausal forms reflect an early stage of the reading tradition is not limited to its interest for the history of that tradition. These forms reflect the way in which the text was commonly understood at some period prior to that of the Masoretes, and can therefore provide information significant for the history of the development of literary units, from the forms identified by scholarly analysis as original, to those of the received text.²

7.3. The vast majority of the verses in the Book of Proverbs are composed of two stichs, each ending (if the word can form one) in a pausal form. In three anomalous cases (compared to 387 with pausal forms), the first stich ends in a contextual form (xxiv. 4, 30, xxx. 21). In longer verses, however, contextual forms occur much more commonly at the end of stichs (xxiii. 5, xxx. 9, 14, 15, 16, 17 compared to 34 with pausal forms). This suggests that these longer verses were also read as composed of two stichs, as suggested by the accents, and not as three or four, as suggested by the wording.³ In the Psalms, however, pausal forms not uncommonly reflect the reading of verses as three stichs (e.g. l. 7, lvi. 9, cxvi. 16, cxxxviii. 2).

7.4. Pausal forms in poetical passages in the prophets similarly sometimes reflect a reading of these passages in individual stichs, as suggested by the wording, as in Isa. lxv. 13. However, verses 8, 9, 12, 15 and 19 of this chapter show stichs which do not end in pausal forms. Presumably, then, the pausal forms reflect a reading tradition which recognised a variety of literary forms in this section, not a poem composed throughout in stichs of more or less equal length.

7.5. The allegory in Ezek. xvi. 1-34 is written as narrative prose, with verbs standing predominantly at the beginning of

¹ That is, the logic behind the division remained the same, but the places where individual divisions were marked may have changed, as occurred when the division marked by the accents superseded that marked by the pausal forms.

² The examples below owe a great deal to a study by W. D. Arbo on Lamentations and other poetical passages in the *Twenty-one books*, and one by Sandra Demson on the Book of Ezekiel, made in connection with a graduate seminar at Toronto.

³ The relationship between the verse division and the use of pausal forms is also very striking in the Book of Lamentations.

their clauses. Pausal forms occur regularly with *atnah* and *silluq* (23 cases), but it is common to find other clauses ending with contextual forms (14 cases in 34 verses, 10 with *zaqef*). In the more direct preaching in Ezek. xvii. 11-xviii. 20, verbs are commonly placed at the ends of clauses. Clauses regularly end with pausal forms, both with *atnah*, and *silluq* (11 cases), and with other accents (16 cases in 34 verses, 13 with *zaqef*). Pausal forms occur twice within a clause. Only four clauses end with contextual forms (one with *zaqef*). Clearly the use of pausal forms suggests that different styles of reading were used in these two prose sections, corresponding to their differences in literary style and content.

7.6. As long as it is held, as it is now, that the distribution of pausal forms is conditioned by the accent system except for (a small proportion of) inexplicable anomalies, the way in which these forms are used in the passages described above can be of no interest. It is the author's hope that this article has demonstrated that the distribution of pausal forms is, in fact, due to the generally accurate preservation of an ancient tradition. If so, the questions raised by the ways in which these forms occur in literary units like those described above are of considerable interest and importance to the history of biblical literature.

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THE OCCURRENCE OF PAUSAL FORMS

E.J. REVELL

UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO



Abstract

The common opinion maintains that the accents determine the occurrence of pausal forms, despite various problems with this view. E.g. any disjunctive accent may be marked on a pausal form, and a few conjunctives are also so marked. Moreover, it is easy to find both contextual and pausal forms of a word marked with the same accent. Syntactic (or more correctly, semantic) structure provides a solid theoretical base for the development of pausal forms than do the accents, a base with fewer problems. The vast majority of pausal forms stand at the end of a clause. The remainder (some 15%) stand within a clause in equally standardized positions, mostly at the main division of the clause as marked by the accents. Consequently, it should be agreed that the occurrence of pausal forms is determined by the syntactic/semantic units making up the text.

1. Pausal, Contextual and Neutral Forms

A pausal form is a form of a word used in particular positions, which differs in features of vowel pattern and/or stress position from the (generally) more common contextual form which is used in other positions.¹ Most words do not form contrasting pausal and contextual forms. Such words are referred to here as 'neutral' forms. A few words produce two different pausal forms contrasting with the contextual form: a 'full' pausal form which shows the full difference from the contextual form both in vowel pattern and in stress position, and a 'minor' pausal form which typically shows the pausal stress position, but the contextual vowel pattern.²

¹ The ways in which pausal forms differ from contextual are described briefly in Joüon and Muraoka 1993, in greater detail in Goerwitz 1993 and in Qimron 2008, and, with even more detail, but an unusually wide understanding of the term 'pausal form', in Ben David 1995.

² It appears that a minor pausal form reveals the pausal stress pattern induced by the position in which it stands, but that this position has not affected the vowel pattern as has occurred in the 'full' pausal form.

2. Accents and Pausal Forms

This paper is mainly concerned with the twenty-one 'prose' books of the Masoretic Text of the Hebrew Bible.³ There are different opinions on the reasons why pausal forms are generated in the particular positions in which they occur in these books. The most common view attributes the occurrence of a pausal form to the accent with which it is marked.⁴ I assume that this view derives directly from the simplified description commonly used in earlier times: pausal forms occur with *atnah* and *silluq* and sometimes with *zaqef*. However, attention to the details of the text shows clearly that this is simply a generalization. It ignores details important for the understanding of the occurrence of pausal forms.

Atnah and *Silluq* are regularly marked on Pausal forms, but also occasionally appear on contextual forms.⁵

Any disjunctive accent may be marked on a pausal form: see note 13, below. Conjunctive accents are also sporadically marked on such forms.

It is easy enough to find the same accent marked either on the pausal form, or on the contextual form, of the same word.⁶ Thus *zaqef* is often marked on the pausal form וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 18:29, 20:4, 28:17, etc., and on the corresponding contextual form וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 3:11, 9:26, Exod. 4:1, etc. Some explanation of these problems is needed if the view that pausal forms are induced by individual accents is to be maintained.⁷ This has not been provided. Consequently it is assumed here that no pausal form is induced by the accent which is marked on it.⁸

³ The Leningrad codex is followed, with chapter and verse divisions as in BHS.

⁴ See e.g. Blau 1976: §11.1, 39; Bergsträsser 1962: I §29a; Ben-David 1995: §0.1.1, 5 and *passim*.

⁵ The cases of *atnah* and *silluq* marked on contextual forms are listed in Geiger 2005: §3.1, 96–9.

⁶ This phenomenon is noted in Bergsträsser 1962: I, §29a, 160. Ben-David 1995: §0.1.1–2, 5–7, correctly explains some such usage with reference to syntax. However he does not consider cases in which there is no obvious syntactic difference, as with וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 3:10, 11, and וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 33:5.

⁷ Geiger (2005: §1, 59–61) accepts that most accents do not induce pausal forms, but argues that *atnah* and *silluq* do do this. However, as far as I know, no attempt has ever been made to demonstrate (rather than simply to state) that the accent marked on the word induces the pausal form; i.e. to show that pausal forms are a feature of the chant, not of the language. *Atnah* and *silluq*, like other accents, represent tropes in the music to which the text was chanted, so there is no reasonable basis for treating them separately.

⁸ The same conclusion was put forward in Revell 1980, but little attention was paid to it. As far as I know, the conclusion has never been contested.

3. Accents and Vowelling in General

Dresher (1994) argues that the accent system has a prosodic basis. Within this, pausal forms mark intonational phrases. Thus far the argument is convincing. However, Dresher goes on to state that the pausal forms which end these intonational phrases are marked by disjunctive accents, which show that the word marked 'is final in its phrase' (Dresher 1994: 3). This is usual, but is not always true. Some 15 pausal forms are marked with conjunctive accents, which, in Dresher's view, show that the word so marked 'is in the same phrase as the word which follows it' (ibid.). Consequently, the assumption that vowels and accents combine harmoniously in the marking of intonational phrases is invalid. This, and other examples, shows that the vowels and the accents of the Masoretic Text do not form a uniform, self-consistent system. Supporting examples are not difficult to find.⁹ Such examples are not numerous — there are only about 15 pausal forms marked with conjunctive accents out of some 7,000. However, these few cases do show that it cannot be assumed, as a matter of course, that the accentuation represents the relationship of words which gave rise to the vowelling.

4. Pausal Forms and Clause Structure

It has also been suggested that pausal forms stand at the end of a clause, or of some other similarly important syntactic structure.¹⁰ This view is generally presented as a supplement to the common view, to be called on where a pausal form is not marked with one of the major accents, *atnah*, *silluq*, or others which may be considered their equivalents, and so also called 'Caesars', or 'pausal accents' (as Ben David 1995: §0.1, 5–7). In fact, however, of the 7,000 or so pausal

⁹ For instance, the inconsistency in the use of *holem* and *qames*, or *sere* and *segol*, in a stressed or unstressed closed final syllable (see Yeivin 1980: §305); the single case of *nesiga* in a word with a disjunctive accent (Num. 23:23); cases of a word with prefixed *waw* with *qames* shown by the accentuation to be separated from the preceding word (e.g., Ps. 10:15, Qoh. 2:23, where the Greek translation treats the words as connected), are all cases in which the vowels and accents reflect different understandings of the passage. See also §14 below.

¹⁰ In this paper, the term 'clause' denotes a simple predicative structure usually composed of a verb and its subject and modifiers, if any. The less common verbless clauses include no verb, but are composed of two other constituents, united by a 'nexus of predication', which is not specifically marked in Biblical Hebrew, but is commonly represented in translations by a form of the verb 'to be'.

forms which occur in the Twenty-one Books, about 85% (over 6,000) stand at the end of a clause.¹¹ The proportion of pausal forms marked with *atnah* and *silluq* is similar, but tends to be somewhat lower.¹² Lesser accents are marked on the remaining pausal forms. Thus pausal forms are marked with *silluq* or *atnah* less frequently than they stand at the end of a clause. Moreover, almost any disjunctive accent may be marked on a pausal form which terminates a clause.¹³ That is to say, the ends of clauses are not marked by particular accents. Occasionally, a pausal form marked with a conjunctive accent terminates a clause. Such cases, and others in which the vowelling is not consistent with the accentuation, are often easily explained as showing that the accentuation and vowelling reflect different understandings of the passage.¹⁴ This range of phenomena clearly confirms the suggestion that the occurrence of a pausal form is not determined by the accent marked on it. It is certainly true that pausal forms occur more commonly with the 'pausal' accents, and less commonly with accents of low status. This is simply because the high status accents are more commonly used to mark the ends of major semantic units. Thus, it is not reasonable to give the accents pride of place above clause structure as the principal cause of the occurrence of pausal forms. Pausal forms delimit the intonational phrases made up of the semantic units of the text. A clause which terminates in a contextual form is shown to be joined in an intonational unit with the following clause, as אָרָץ (Gen. 1:10), קָן (Gen. 4:1), יִדְעָתִי (Gen. 4:9). Accents mark the music of the chant and merely confirm (in most cases) the delimitation marked by the pausal forms.

¹¹ The numbers given here and elsewhere in this paper are intended for purposes of comparison, to give a general idea of the numbers involved, not a precise count. The figures, and indeed, the list of pausal forms studied here, are derived from the lists published in Revell 2012.

¹² The proportion is highest in the books of the Pentateuch, as in Genesis: *silluq* 43%, *atnah* 40%, in Deuteronomy: s. 38%, a. 35%. In the Former Prophets, the proportion is similar, but in the Latter Prophets, it is lower, as in Isaiah: s. 35%, a. 39%, in the Twelve Prophets: s. 34%, a. 38%.

¹³ Clauses are terminated by pausal forms marked with *silluq* (Gen. 1:20), *atnah* (Gen. 1:5), *segolta* (Gen. 3:17), *šalsēlet* (Gen. 19:16), *zaqef* (Gen. 3:17), *revia* (Gen. 28:15), *ṭifṭa* (Gen. 3:10), *pašṭa* (Gen. 27:37), *tevir* (Jer. 9:2), *gereš* (Deut. 24:19), *legarmeh* (Lev. 10:6), *pazer* (2 Kgs 3:25), and *teliša* (Ezek. 20:21). *Zarqa* is occasionally marked on a pausal form (as in 2 Sam. 3:8), but not at the end of a clause.

¹⁴ So Bergsträsser 1962: I, §29a, 160, and see §14 below.

5. Pausal Forms within a Clause

Pausal forms which stand within clauses (a little over 900 in number, some 15% of the total) are used only in a limited range of positions, and are used sporadically rather than regularly. A pausal form is often used at the end of an item, or a group of items, in a list. A pausal form is sometimes used at the end of an 'Introduction to Speech' (ISP, see below §9). Lists and ISPs constitute special situations governed by their own conventions. 'Ordinary' clauses, those which do not include lists or ISPs, are made up from a small number of constituents: a verb, an adverb, an infinitival phrase, a nominal phrase acting as subject, as a term of address (vocative), as modifier, alone, or with an introductory preposition, as a prepositional phrase. Relative clauses are here considered to form part of the same constituent as the noun they modify. Other subordinate clauses are treated as independent. A pausal form within a clause most commonly stands before the terminal constituent. It may also stand at the end of the initial constituent of the clause, or before two or more constituents which end the clause. It rarely appears in other positions. In whichever of the three main positions a pausal form is used, it typically stands at the main division of the clause. That is, it is marked by the accent which marks the main division of the clause. The accent which marks a pausal form within a clause is most commonly *atnah*. *Zaqef* and *tifha* are also frequently used. Many of the other disjunctive accents sometimes mark a pausal form within a clause, although they are less commonly used.¹⁵ The following examples illustrate the way pausal forms are used within clauses.

6. Pause Ending the First Constituent

Pause ending the initial constituent of the clause is relatively rare, occurring in some 75 cases. The initial constituent appears to be isolated from the remainder of the clause by the terminal pausal form, and so to be highlighted, adding to the attention drawn to it by its clause-initial position. The constituent so terminated may be extraposed (may stand outside the clause, and be represented within it, usually by a pronoun). The subject of the clause is most frequently treated in this way, as in 1 Kgs 5:19:

¹⁵ According to my lists, the only disjunctive accents which are not used within a clause are *legarmeh* and *teliša*.

בְּנֵךְ אֲשֶׁר אַתָּן תַּחֲתֶיךָ עַל־כִּסְאֶךָ הוּא־יִבְנֶה הַבַּיִת לַשָּׁמַיִם:

Also Lev. 11:12, 1 Kgs 14:19, etc. The object is also sometimes extraposed, as in Exod. 12:44, Num. 30:14. Pause may also be used after an initial constituent which is not extraposed, as a prepositional phrase, in Deut. 9:11, 2 Sam. 8:8, Isa. 33:3, Mic. 7:5, etc., or an initial nominal phrase acting as subject or object, as in Gen. 15:14, Exod. 30:14, Jer. 52:19, 1 Chron. 29:26. A term of address may also be treated in this way, as in 1 Kgs 17:21:

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי תַשָּׁב נָא נֶפֶשׁ־הַיֶּלֶד הַזֶּה עַל־קִרְבּוֹ:

Also 1 Kgs 17:20.

7. Pause preceding the Terminal Constituent

A pausal form standing within a clause most commonly precedes the terminal constituent (nearly 400 cases). Pause in this position appears often to end the basic core of the clause, thus isolating, and so drawing attention to, the additional information provided by the terminal constituent. Any constituent may be treated in this way. Cases of pause preceding the terminal constituent of a verbless clause are included in this group, as in Dan. 8:20,

הָאֵיל אֲשֶׁר־רָאִיתָ בְּעַל הַקִּרְנַיִם מַלְכֵי מְדֵי וּפְרָס:

also in Num 13:8, etc., and, with minor pausal form, Jer. 17:17. The subject of the verbal clause is isolated in this way in Isa. 7:22,

כִּי־חֲמָאָה וּדְבַשׁ יֹאכַל כָּל־הַנוֹתָר בְּקֶרֶב הָאָרֶץ:

also in Gen. 46:6, as is the object or other nominal modifier in 2 Sam. 1:1, Isa. 64:3, etc., or a prepositional phrase in Gen. 29:19, 1 Sam. 9:21, 1 Kgs 17:14, Isa. 14:15, 1 Chron. 28:1, etc. A term of address may also be isolated at the end of a clause, as it may at the beginning, as in Gen. 27:34, 38, 1 Kgs 17:18, 2 Chron. 35:21. Finally, although defined above as forming part of the same constituent as the noun it modifies, a relative clause quite often follows a pausal form as the terminal element in a clause, as in Exod. 1:8,

וַיָּקָם מֶלֶךְ־חֲדָשׁ עַל־מִצְרַיִם אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָדַע אֶת־יוֹסֵף:

also in 2 Sam. 3:8, Isa. 18:1, Neh. 1:10, etc. Nominal additions to, or modifiers of, constituents are likewise often added at the end of a clause following a pausal form, as in Deut. 4:16, 7:21, 1 Kgs 5:31 etc.

8. Pause Elsewhere within a Clause

Pause within a clause is used in other positions (commonly before two or more constituents which end the clause) in about 150 cases. The constituents following the pausal form in this position are often parallel, suggesting a form of hendiadys — with a single semantic unit presented in several phrases. Consequently, in this case, the pausal form precedes, and isolates, the terminal semantic constituent, rather than a terminal group of syntactic constituents. In a number of cases this embellishes poetic structure, as in Mic. 1:4

וּנְמָסוּ הַהָרִים תַּחֲתֵי וְהַעֲמָקִים יִתְבַּקְּעוּ כְּדֹנָג מִפְּנֵי הָאֵשׁ כְּמִים מְגֹרֵרִים בְּמֹרֶד:

also in Isa. 1:8, 30:2, Song 1:5, etc. Examples are also common enough in prose, as in Gen. 24:11, Exod. 8:1, 1 Kgs 3:13, Isa. 45:13, etc. However, two or more constituents ending a clause after a pausal form often do not present the same idea, as in 2 Kgs 20:17.

הִנֵּה יָמִים בָּאִים וְנִשְׂאָא | כָּל-אֲשֶׁר בְּבֵיתְךָ וְאֲשֶׁר אֶצְרִי אֲבִיתְךָ עַד-הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה בְּבִלְהִי

also in Lev. 24:6, Jer. 27:13, Qoh. 11:6, etc.

9. Pause Ending an 'Introduction to Speech'

A Pausal form terminates an introduction to speech in about 150 cases. 'Introduction to speech' (ISP) is the name used here for any structure which stands before and introduces quoted speech.¹⁶ An introductory verb of speaking may stand alone (as in the examples given in note 19 below), or one or more verbs may be used along with other information, providing, for instance, the identities of the speaker and/or the addressee, as in Gen. 4:6.¹⁷ The following speech is here seen as the object of the verb of speaking which introduces it, so that a pausal form terminating the introduction is seen as standing within the clause.¹⁸ A pausal form terminating an ISP typically stands

¹⁶ This term is used in preference to the more usual 'quotative frame' since no 'framework' exists. The end of a speech is typically not marked.

¹⁷ Often a descriptive verb (as וַיַּעַן, וַיְתַּדֵּר), is used along with the basic verb of speaking (usually a form of אָמַר or דִּבֶּר).

¹⁸ Ben-David 1995, in the example from 1 Sam. 15:32 given in §0.1.2 (p. 7), states that the noun ending the ISP וַיֹּאמֶר אֲנִי is pausal in form because it ends a דִּבּוּר (utterance, expression), as is true for אָהַת, which ends a clause (in the terms used in this paper), in Amos 4:7. However, the words clearly belong to different categories, as some 6,000 (85% of) pausal forms terminate clauses, while only some 150 end introductions to speech, a small proportion of the total possible.

at the main division of the unit formed by the ISP and the first semantic unit of the speech. This unit may include the whole of a short and simple speech, as in 1 Sam. 15:32, Ruth 2:6. The first semantic unit of a speech often itself ends in a pausal form, as in the following examples:

The blessing of Melchizedek in Gen. 14:19

וַיְבָרֶכְהוּ וַיֹּאמֶר בְּרוּךְ אֲבִרָם לֹאֵל עֲלִיּוֹן קִנָּה שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ:

Hannah vows to consecrate to the Lord the son (Samuel) for whom she is praying in 1 Sam. 1:11

וַתֵּדֶר נָדָר וַתֹּאמֶר יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אִם־רָאָה תִּרְאֶה | בְּעֵינַי אֶמְתֶּךָ וּזְכַרְתִּי וְלֹא־תִשְׁכַּח
אֶת־אֶמְתְּךָ ...

The Lord prepares the prophet Jeremiah for the duty of delivering a prophecy of doom in Jer. 11:9

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֵלַי נִמְצָא־קֶשֶׁר בְּאִישׁ יְהוּדָה וּבִישָׁבִי יְרוּשָׁלַם:

An introduction to speech most commonly ends with a contextual or a neutral form. The occasional use of a pausal form appears to mark the speech as particularly important, as in the above examples.¹⁹ Thus, it is clear that the use of a pausal form at the end of an introduction to speech is determined by conventions different from those determining the use of a pausal form within an 'ordinary' clause.

10. Pausal Forms in Typical Lists

Pausal forms terminate items, or units formed of groups of items, which make up a list, in over 100 cases. A list is here defined as a set of successive words, phrases, or clauses, which are used in parallel in that each performs the same function in the clause, or in the wider context in which they stand. Where the items composing the list are

¹⁹ Other examples are provided by the verse-initial pausal form וַיֹּאמֶר which introduces Abraham's polite invitation to the angels in Gen. 18:3, and leads to the promise that a son will be born to him. In Gen. 19:7 the same form introduces Lot's plea to his neighbours not to molest his guests, which forestalls the proposed criminal action. Both events are significant for the biblical narrative. In Gen. 19:2, the contrasting contextual form וַיֹּאמֶר, also verse-initial, introduces Lot's less hospitable invitation to the angels. This resulted in the saving of Lot and his family, an event of limited significance in the biblical story. An introduction to speech which is presented as a verse also marks the following speech as important, as in Exod. 25:1, Lev. 4:1, Num. 2:1, etc.

relatively long, each may terminate in a pausal form, as in 1 Chron. 1:8 and similar passages. Where the items composing the list are relatively short, two or three are usually grouped to form a unit which also typically terminates in a pausal form. Each such unit is occasionally treated as a verse, as in Lev. 14:54–6, Neh. 7:48–9, 55, etc., so the pausal form ending each is marked with *silluq*. More commonly, these lists formed from short items are included within a verse. In this situation, the end of each unit, and so any terminal pausal form, is typically marked with some other disjunctive accent. This provides a sharp contrast with the typical situation of a pausal form used within an ordinary clause, marked, as it is, with the accent marking the main division of the clause. An example where short items are grouped in a list occurs in Deut. 16:14:

וְשִׂמְחַת בַּחֲגֹף אֹתָהּ וּבִנְיָהּ וּבִתְּךָ וְעַבְדְּךָ וְאִמְתְּךָ וְהַלְוִי וְהַגֵּר וְהִיטָּוּם וְהָאֱלֻמָּה
אֲשֶׁר בְּשַׁעְרֶיךָ:

Similar examples are provided by other lists which begin with the group אֹתָהּ וּבִנְיָהּ וּבִתְּךָ (Exod. 20:10, Deut. 5:14, 12:18, 16:11). Other examples, formed from somewhat longer items, occur in Gen. 49:25, Exod. 7:28, Deut. 12:17; also 1 Sam. 22:14:

וְיָמִי בְּכָל־עַבְדֶּיךָ כְּדֹדִי נֶאֱמָן וְחֹתֵן הַמֶּלֶךְ וְסֹר אֶל־מִשְׁמַעְתְּךָ וְנִכְבְּד בְּבֵיתְךָ:

Lists of names are often arranged so that a pausal form is used only at the main division of a verse, or at its end, and so is marked with *atnah* or *silluq* as in Gen. 10:26. This is also the case with most lists of longer items, as Deut. 28:18–19:

אֲרוּר פְּרִי־בִטְנֶךָ וּפְרִי אֲדָמָתְךָ שֹׁגֵר אֶלְפִיךָ וְעִשְׁתְּרוֹת צֹאנֶךָ: אֲרוּר אֹתָהּ בְּבֹאֶה
וְאֲרוּר אֹתָהּ בְּצֵאתְךָ:

also Exod. 21:24–5, Lev. 7:12, Ezra 10:28, etc. However, as most words are neutral forms, so lists, in many cases, contain only scattered pausal forms. These also are likely to be marked with *atnah* or *silluq*, as in 1 Kgs 4:8–9.

11. Pausal Forms in 'Non-Conformist' Lists

The above description covers the most obvious examples of lists. However, there are a few other lists which do not conform to the above patterns. In 1 Kgs 1:26,

וְלִי אֲנִי־עַבְדְּךָ וְלִצְדִּיק הַכֹּהֵן וּלְבִנְיָהּ בְּנֵי־יְהוֹיָדָע וּלְשִׁלְמָה עַבְדָּהּ לֹא קָרָא:

the first item in the list ends with a pausal form, the second and third items end with neutral forms, and the fourth and final item ends with a contextual form.²⁰ There is a similar situation in the list of three items in 1 Kgs 20:25. The final clause in Exod. 20:17 (cf. Deut. 5:21) appears to be of the same type, although the final item ends with a pausal form.

לֹא תִחְמַד בֵּית רֶעֶךָ לֹא-תִחְמַד אִשְׁתְּ רֶעֶךָ וְעַבְדּוֹ וְאִמָּתוֹ וְשׁוֹרֹךְ וְחִמְרוֹ וְכָל אֲשֶׁר
לְרֶעֶךָ:

As these examples suggest, the convention, in these 'non-conformist' lists, appears to be that the first item in the list ends with a pausal or neutral form. This form is typically (cf. n. 20) marked with an accent which marks the main division of a unit comprising the complete list, or the initial section of it (semantically defined).²¹ This first item is also typically the most important in the list, and can sometimes be considered as comprehending all items listed (as in Deut. 30:9). Items following the first in the list, including the last, may end with a neutral, pausal or contextual form. This convention appears to be followed in the lists named above, and also in Gen. 17:12, Deut. 8:7, 9:1, 11:14, 30:9, Isa. 28:2, and also 2 Kgs 19:13, assuming that the last two words in the verse are not part of the list of kings. This description also applies to the list in Deut. 6:7 and 11:19, where the first item ends with the pausal form *בְּבִיתְךָ*. The two following items end with contextual forms, but the fourth and last item is the pausal form, *וּבְקוֹמְךָ*. The accents present items in these lists in two contrasting pairs, and so present the list in a conventional form, contrasting with the vowelling (see §14). There is a similar case in Deut. 30:9, although there the list does not end with a pausal form.

12. Pause in the Three 'Poetical' Books

The general description of the use of pausal forms in the Twenty-one Books, and so these conclusions, is also valid for their use in the

²⁰ This is marked with *tifba*, which marks the main division of the clause, so that the accentuation is not consistent with the vowelling. The initial pausal form, marked with the accent *tešā*, may mark what was originally the main division. I doubt if Ben-David (1995: §0.1.1, 5–6) is right in suggesting that *אֵלֵי אֲנִי עַבְדְּךָ* is to be considered a separate clause. It is simply an item in a list, similar to *אֶתָּה וּבְנֵי-יִשְׂרָאֵל* (Exod. 20:10), which is also an item in a list ending in a pausal form marked with *tešā*.

²¹ E.g., in Exod. 20:17, Deut. 5:21, the accent *revia* marks the main division of the section of the list ending *וְחִמְרוֹ*. This section covers individual items; the concluding section is general and comprehensive.

Three 'Poetical' books: Psalms, Job, Proverbs. However, the Three Books are composed in relatively short clauses, which provide, at their ends, more frequent opportunity for the use of pausal forms than do the longer clauses of the Twenty-one Books. On the other hand, the use of pausal forms within clauses in the Three Books is correspondingly reduced.²² Less than one in ten of the more than 2,250 pausal forms in the Three Books is used within a clause. The use of pausal forms within clauses in the poetical books follows the same general pattern as it does in the prose books, but clause structure in the poetical books is more varied, so that the description of the positions in which pausal forms are used within clauses in the prose books would need to be considerably expanded to cover their use in the poetical books adequately. However, the notable fact that a pausal form within a clause typically stands at the main division of the clause is equally valid in both, as is shown for the Three Books by the common examples where a pausal form within a clause is marked with the accent marking the main division of the verse: 'Oleh weyored, as in Ps. 56:14, Job 32:6 etc., or *atnah*, as in Ps. 2:2, Job 4:6, Prov. 1:17 etc., or even *revia* (*mugraṣ*) as in Ps. 128:4:

הִנֵּה כִּי־כֵן יִבְרַךְ גִּבּוֹר יִרְאֵהוּ:

Also Job 33:24. If *atnah* does not stand at the main division of a verse, it may, even so, mark a pausal form at the main division of a clause, as in Ps. 22:15:

כַּמִּים נִשְׁפַּכְתִּי וְהִתְפַּרְדִּי כָּל־עֲצָמוֹתַי הָיָה לִבִּי כְדוֹנָנִי נִמְסָה בְּתוֹךְ מֵצִי:

Other accents, of course, may also mark the main division of a clause, as *sinnor* in Job 7:20:

חָטָאתִי מֶה אַפְעֵל | לִךְ נֹצֵר הָאָדָם

Also Ps. 79:13. *Dehi* can also be used in this way, as in Ps. 45:2, 66:15.

Occasionally, a pausal form is marked with a conjunctive accent. In the Three Books, this seems mainly due to carelessness.²³ In any

²² This tendency is also visible in the latter prophets, where the 200 cases of pause within a clause form a much smaller proportion of the total pausal forms (about 10% of over 2,000) than do those in the Torah (329 of 1850, about 17%) and Former Prophets (183 of 1250 about 13%), or those in the prose writings (220 of 739, about 29%).

²³ As with *למשפטך* (with *munah* Ps. 119:43), *כמשפטך* (with *merka*, Ps. 119:149), probably due to the defective writing of a plural noun. In Ps. 93:1, the pointing of *לבש* (with *munah*) may be influenced by the preceding *לבש* (with 'Oleh weyored), which ends a clause. In Prov. 25:3 *וארץ* (with *munah*), though separated by one

case, these forms, if correctly identified as pausal, most probably only reflect the fact that, when the accentuation was fixed in the text, pausal forms had come to be regarded as undetermined variations of the contextual form (see n. 29 below).

13. Pause Marking Several Divisions in a Clause

In the discussion of the material in the Twenty-one Books, it was suggested that all pausal forms within ordinary clauses stand at the main division of the clause, but this is not entirely correct. A small proportion of them mark other divisions. For example, in Ezek. 44:5, the pausal form **שָׁמַע** is marked with *revia*, which marks it as the main divider of the core of the clause (free of the terminal prepositional phrases), which ends with the pausal form **אֶתָּךְ**, marked with *zaqef*. This word marks the main division of the complete clause, which extends to **תּוֹרָתוֹ**, marked with *atnah*. Thus the pausal forms divide this clause into three parts. The same is true in 2 Sam. 24:13, in a clause composed of a verb and a prepositional modifier, followed by three nominal phrases presenting alternative questions, each of which ends with a pausal form. The first of these forms, **בְּאַרְצֶךָ**, is marked with *pazer*, which marks it as the main divider of the unit ending with the second pausal form, **רִדְפְּךָ**. This word is marked with *revia*, which shows it to be the main divider of the unit ending with the third pausal form, again **בְּאַרְצֶךָ**, which is marked with *zaqef*, and ends the clause. However, most words do not appear in contrasting pausal and contextual forms. In several cases a pausal form which does not stand at the main division of a clause can be assumed to show that that clause was divided into more than two sections. For example, **רָכַשׁ** (Gen. 31:18) is marked with *zaqef*, as the main divider of the unit ending **אֲרָם** marked with *atnah*, whereas the clause ends with **כְּנָעַן** marked with *silluq*. Presumably the clause was also divided at **אֲרָם**, although that word, being a neutral form, could not mark the division. Similar cases occur in Gen. 17:7 **וּבְיִנֶכָה**, and in Jer. 22:25 **נִפְשֶׁךָ**, which both mark the main division of the *atnah* unit, in a clause which continues for the whole verse. There is some reason to suppose

word from the preceding **שָׁמַע** may have been influenced by the common pair **וְאֶרְץ**. In this case, and the similar one in Isa. 65:17, the word is marked with a conjunctive accent, which is unusual. A word with prefixed *waw* with *qames* is typically marked with a disjunctive accent, as is the even more surprising use of **וְאֶרְץ** in Isa. 26:19. These three cases can only be treated as anomalies, as was already recognized by the Masoretes.

that, occasionally, a clause may have been divided into more than three parts. In Dan. 9:24, קִדְשָׁךְ, marked with *revia*, marks the main division of the unit ending עֶנְךָ, which is marked with *zaqef*. If pause was used at this *zaqef*, and also at the following *atnah*, the clause would have been divided into four parts. Pausal forms do not, however, always suggest neat divisions of a verse. In Deut. 30:9, יִדְךָ marked with *revia*, should mark the main division of the unit ending אֲדַמְתֶּךָ which is marked with *tifha*; however the clause ends with the following word, which is marked with *atnah*. There is a similar case in 2 Kgs 20:17 (see §8) and in Isa. 39:6. This phenomenon of subdivision of semantic units is not restricted to clauses. The introduction to speech in Isa. 44:24 ends with the pausal form מִכְּטֶן but the unit is divided internally by the pausal form גִּאֲלֶךָ. There is a similar case in Ezek. 44:6, where the ISP ends with the neutral form יִשְׂרָאֵל but is divided by the pausal form מִרִּי. Similarly, the initial constituent of a clause is occasionally divided by a pausal form, as in Lev. 18:9. These cases support the conclusion that, as in verses, in long or complex semantic units, most of which are clauses, divisions are marked by pausal forms not only at the main division in the unit, but also in other positions rendered suitable by the semantic structure of the passage.

14. Vowels and Accents Representing Different Understandings of a Verse

A small number of pausal forms which are not marked with the accent marking the main division of a clause, appear to represent cases in which vowelling and accentuation reflect different understandings of the passage.²⁴ For example, the two cases in which a conjunctive accent is marked on a pausal form terminating a protasis in Mal. 1:6

וְאִם־אֵב אֲנִי אֵיךְ כְּבוֹדִי וְאִם־אֲדוֹנִים אֲנִי אֵיךְ מוֹרָאִי

The vowelling here presumably reflects a tradition in which each of the two protases was treated as an independent clause which was followed by an apodosis.²⁵ The structure of the passage as composed of

²⁴ An example has been given above in n. 20 to §11. This phenomenon is not restricted to pausal forms, but is also reflected in other situations in which the accents are not consistent with the vowelling. See n. 9 to §3.

²⁵ A protasis is terminated by a pausal form in some 50 other cases, as Gen. 31:52, Exod. 7:27, Lev. 2:7, Num. 14:28, Deut. 20:12, etc. For Ben-David, the vowelling of אֲנִי in Mal. 1:6 is due to the preceding predicate (1995: 88, §5), whereas אִם־אֲדוֹנִים

two conditional sentences was thus highlighted, emphasizing the question of whether the speaker is, in fact, a 'father' or a 'Lord'. The accentuation reflects a tradition in which the two conditional sentences were each treated as an undivided unit. This highlights the value of the passage as presenting two questions, emphasizing the problem of whether the speaker was in fact treated as 'father' or 'Lord'. This change accounts for the use of a conjunctive accent to mark the pausal forms.²⁶ Such treatment implies that pausal and contextual forms were treated as unconditioned variants (see n. 29 below). Change in the understanding of the passage also appears to have occurred in the list in Deut. 6:7 and 11:19. This has been treated as an example of a 'non-conformist' style of list in §11 above, as suggested by the vowelling. In contrast, the accentuation presents it as a typical list of short items grouped in pairs, so that **בְּיָתֶךָ**, which is marked with *pašta*, is expected to show a contextual form, and **בְּדֶרֶךְךָ**, marked with *zaqef*, to which the *pašta* is subordinate, is expected to show a pausal form (as noted in Ben-David 1995: §0.0.0, 1). A similar inconsistency appears to occur in Deut. 18:4, where **צִאֲנֶךָ**, marked with *tifha*, which marks the main division of the verse and the clause in terms of the accents, is a contextual form, while the preceding **וַיִּצְהָרְךָ**, marked with *revia* subordinate to the *tifha*, is pausal in form. It seems quite probable that **וַיִּצְהָרְךָ**, rather than **צִאֲנֶךָ**, marked the main division of the verse when the vowelling was fixed.²⁷ Another similar case occurs in Deut. 15:11, where the pausal form **לְעִנִּיךָ** is marked with *tevir*, whereas the following **וּלְאֲבִינֶךָ**, marked with *tifha*, to which the *tevir* is subordinate, is contextual in form. Possibly, **לְעִנִּיךָ** was considered the main division of the clause when the vowelling was fixed.²⁸ In Exod. 10:4, the marking of *munah* on the pausal form **לְשִׁלַּח** has been explained by Ben-David as due to

and **וְאִם-אֵתָהּ** (showing 'minor' pause) in Gen. 31:52 are incomplete clauses (ibid. p. 105, n. 224).

²⁶ Other examples of pausal forms marked with conjunctive accents are discussed in Revell 2011.

²⁷ So Breuer 1992: 225. Geiger 2005: 103 suggests that the pointing in this case was not conditioned by the accents, but was influenced by the four other uses of the same words (Deut. 7:13, 11:14, 12:17, 14:23). Ben-David 1995: 74, n. 126, points out that **וַיִּצְהָרְךָ**, in contextual form, does not occur. It should, however, be noted, that, in all five cases, the pausal form of this word stands at the end of a unit in a list, where pause is to be expected.

²⁸ Ben-David argues (1995: §1.5.1.1, 67) that **לְעִנִּיךָ** is, itself, contextual in form. However, the understanding of this form as pausal is compatible with the structure of the feminine form **עֲנִיָּה** (Isa. 54:11, etc.), so it seems unlikely that Ben-David is correct.

an addition to the text made after the vowelling had been fixed.²⁹ Another possibility is that it derives from a form of tradition in which it (rather than the contextual form **אָתָהּ** as marked by the accents) stood at the main division of the clause. A similar case occurs in **שָׁפֵט אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל** (1 Sam. 7:17). The pausal form of **שָׁפֵט** may reflect a tradition in which this word, and not the preceding adverb **שָׁם**, stood at the main division of the clause.³⁰ These cases would then each provide a typical example of a pausal form, marked by the accent marking the main division of the clause, standing before the final constituent of the clause. In Deut. 4:26 the apparently pausal form **תִּאֲכָדוּן** might possibly show that the clause was divided into more than two sections. I can suggest no explanation for the use of the similar form **יִשְׁאָלוּן** in Jos. 4:6 and 4:21.

15. Pausal Forms in Clauses and Verses

It seems clear that the use of a pausal form within an ordinary clause is related to the use of such a form within a verse. Indeed, the two are often identical, as in Gen. 11:1, Deut. 6:9, 1 Chron. 29:26, etc. The pausal form typically marks the main division in the clause, just as it usually does in a verse. The pausal form marking the main division of an ordinary clause may be marked with a variety of accents, but most commonly a strong accent is used: *atnah*, *zaqef*, or *tifha*, accents which also mark a pausal form at the main division of a verse. However, a pausal form marking the main division of a clause may be marked with some other disjunctive accent. This makes it clear that the occurrence of a pausal form is not determined by the individual accent marked on it, but by its position in the language of the text. It is determined by the fact that it ends, or marks the main division of, a significant semantic or syntactic unit. A word does not appear in pausal form because it is marked by *atnah* or

²⁹ Ben-David 1995: §2.3.1.6.2, n. 24 (p. 132) suggests that the words **אֶת־עַמִּי** were added to wording copied, complete with vowelling, from Exod. 7:27, 9:2. This addition necessitated a change in the accentuation. As a result, the (accentual) word **אֶת־עַמִּי** is marked with *atnah*, and the preceding pausal form **לִשְׁלַח** with a conjunctive. This would imply that the significance of the pausal form was not recognized; it was regarded as simply a chance variant of the contextual form.

³⁰ Ben-David 1995: §2.4.1.3 (p.138) suggests that the pausal vowelling of **שָׁפֵט** was introduced to avoid cacophony, citing the note to G.K. §29i in support. That note, however, ignores the fact that the words **שָׁפֵט אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל**, with the same verb in contextual form and with a conjunctive accent, occur in Judg. 16:31 and 1 Sam. 4:18.

silluq, but because it stands at the main division of a verse, or at its end. The same is true of any other accent with pausal forms in other positions. These pausal forms stand at the end of a clause, or at its main division, or occasionally at some other significant break within a clause (as described in §13). The accents with which they are marked are chosen according to the conventions of the accent system, based on the understanding of the passage at the time of their introduction. It can be argued that where a pausal form ends an ISP, or is used to mark one of two or more divisions in a clause, the pausal form can still be seen as marking the main division of a semantic unit, as shown in §13. That unit may not be a clause in terms of syntax, but this is also true of many verses. This suggests that the divisions marked by pausal forms also mark a form of 'dichotomy', imperfect though it might be, in much the same way as do the accents. That is, pausal forms have no relationship with the individual accents marked in the biblical text, but they do, in fact, mark basic structures in the same or a similar way as does the accenuation.

16. All Pausal Forms are Equally Significant

This survey has shown that the system of pausal forms is not simply a matter of their significant regular use when marked with strong accents, such as *silluq* and *atnah*, and their occasional, relatively unimportant, use elsewhere. In fact, pausal forms are used in a regular way, at the main division of a semantic unit, and at its end, in almost all cases. Thus, a pausal form is used at the end of a clause, unless that clause forms a semantic unit with one or more other clauses. It may also be used at the main division of a clause, and occasionally elsewhere within it. The use of pausal forms within clauses is sporadic in that it fails to occur in many clauses, but is regular in that (with rare exceptions), the pausal form is used at the main division of the clause, or to end some other significant semantic unit. It may not be obvious why a pausal form is used at the main division of one clause but not that of another, but this is also true of the use of pausal forms at the main division of a verse which does not use *atnah*,³¹ and, indeed, why the main division of one verse is marked with *tifha* and that of another

³¹ Most accents marking the main division of a verse in which *atnah* is not used are marked on neutral forms. The few pausal and contextual forms marked with *tifha* or *zaqef* where one of these is the main divider of the verse are listed in Geiger 2005: §3.2–3, 99–104.

with *atnah*.³² I assume that such questions could be answered only after a comprehensive study of the basis of the division of the text into verses, and into smaller units within the verses. The above discussion has shown quite clearly that the occurrence of pausal forms in a passage is determined by syntactic and semantic units of which the passage is composed. The relation of these forms to the accents is determined simply by the choice of accents used to delimit these units.

17. Conclusion

This survey can, then, conclude that the occurrence of pausal forms is not determined by the accents which mark them, but by the syntactic, or, more properly, the semantic structure of the text. Most pausal forms stand at the end of a clause. A proportion stand at the main division, or, occasionally, also at subsidiary divisions of a clause. These positions account not only for the greater number of pausal forms, which are marked with *sillug* and *atnah*, but also for the others, no less important, which may be marked with any other disjunctive accent. Pausal forms, then, mark the end and the middle of clauses in much the same way as they do the ends and middle of verses, and so can be said to mark the so-called dichotomy much as do the accents. This suggests that the tendency to mark 'dichotomy' was a feature of the Hebrew language, not simply of the biblical chant. It also suggests that the vowelling, or, some features of it, was fixed in the text before the accentuation. This is not to suggest that minor details of either system, such as conjunctive accents, and composite or simple *shewas*, were all fixed in place at this time, but simply that pausal forms delimiting the basic units of the text were fixed in place before the accentuation was introduced. It seems most likely that, although the pausal forms were preserved in the traditional vowelling when the accents were introduced, they were regarded, by that time, simply as free variants of the contextual forms. This is shown by the marking of some forms with conjunctive accents, or other accents inconsistent with the pausal vowelling (see §14 and n. 29). If the accentuation was in place first, and conditioned the vowelling, as is commonly supposed, the vowelling should be consistent with the accentuation. This is often not the case (see §3 and n. 9). It does not seem possible that such inconsistency should have occurred if the vowelling were fixed

³² See Geiger 2005: 99. Wickes describes the choice, in certain cases, as 'entirely optional' (1887: 63).

after the accentuation was in place, and determined the presentation of the text.

Address for Correspondence: ejrevell@eastlink.ca
48 Whidden Street, Antigonish NS, Canada B2G 2Z2

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THE OCCURRENCE OF PAUSAL FORMS

E.J. REVELL

UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO

Abstract

The common opinion maintains that the accents determine the occurrence of pausal forms, despite various problems with this view. E.g. any disjunctive accent may be marked on a pausal form, and a few conjunctives are also so marked. Moreover, it is easy to find both contextual and pausal forms of a word marked with the same accent. Syntactic (or more correctly, semantic) structure provides a solid theoretical base for the development of pausal forms than do the accents, a base with fewer problems. The vast majority of pausal forms stand at the end of a clause. The remainder (some 15%) stand within a clause in equally standardized positions, mostly at the main division of the clause as marked by the accents. Consequently, it should be agreed that the occurrence of pausal forms is determined by the syntactic/semantic units making up the text.

1. Pausal, Contextual and Neutral Forms

A pausal form is a form of a word used in particular positions, which differs in features of vowel pattern and/or stress position from the (generally) more common contextual form which is used in other positions.¹ Most words do not form contrasting pausal and contextual forms. Such words are referred to here as 'neutral' forms. A few words produce two different pausal forms contrasting with the contextual form: a 'full' pausal form which shows the full difference from the contextual form both in vowel pattern and in stress position, and a 'minor' pausal form which typically shows the pausal stress position, but the contextual vowel pattern.²

¹ The ways in which pausal forms differ from contextual are described briefly in Jouon and Muraoka 1993, in greater detail in Goerwitz 1993 and in Qimron 2008, and, with even more detail, but an unusually wide understanding of the term 'pausal form', in Ben David 1995.

² It appears that a minor pausal form reveals the pausal stress pattern induced by the position in which it stands, but that this position has not affected the vowel pattern as has occurred in the 'full' pausal form.

2. Accents and Pausal Forms

This paper is mainly concerned with the twenty-one 'prose' books of the Masoretic Text of the Hebrew Bible.³ There are different opinions on the reasons why pausal forms are generated in the particular positions in which they occur in these books. The most common view attributes the occurrence of a pausal form to the accent with which it is marked.⁴ I assume that this view derives directly from the simplified description commonly used in earlier times: pausal forms occur with *atnah* and *silluq* and sometimes with *zaqef*. However, attention to the details of the text shows clearly that this is simply a generalization. It ignores details important for the understanding of the occurrence of pausal forms.

Atnah and *Silluq* are regularly marked on Pausal forms, but also occasionally appear on contextual forms.⁵

Any disjunctive accent may be marked on a pausal form: see note 13, below. Conjunctive accents are also sporadically marked on such forms.

It is easy enough to find the same accent marked either on the pausal form, or on the contextual form, of the same word.⁶ Thus *zaqef* is often marked on the pausal form וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 18:29, 20:4, 28:17, etc., and on the corresponding contextual form וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 3:11, 9:26, Exod. 4:1, etc. Some explanation of these problems is needed if the view that pausal forms are induced by individual accents is to be maintained.⁷ This has not been provided. Consequently it is assumed here that no pausal form is induced by the accent which is marked on it.⁸

³ The Leningrad codex is followed, with chapter and verse divisions as in BHS.

⁴ See e.g. Blau 1976: §11.1, 39; Bergsträsser 1962: I §29a; Ben-David 1995: §0.1.1, 5 and *passim*.

⁵ The cases of *atnah* and *silluq* marked on contextual forms are listed in Geiger 2005: §3.1, 96–9.

⁶ This phenomenon is noted in Bergsträsser 1962: I, §29a, 160. Ben-David 1995: §0.1.1–2, 5–7, correctly explains some such usage with reference to syntax. However he does not consider cases in which there is no obvious syntactic difference, as with וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 3:10, 11, and וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 33:5.

⁷ Geiger (2005: §1, 59–61) accepts that most accents do not induce pausal forms, but argues that *atnah* and *silluq* do do this. However, as far as I know, no attempt has ever been made to demonstrate (rather than simply to state) that the accent marked on the word induces the pausal form; i.e. to show that pausal forms are a feature of the chant, not of the language. *Atnah* and *silluq*, like other accents, represent tropes in the music to which the text was chanted, so there is no reasonable basis for treating them separately.

⁸ The same conclusion was put forward in Revell 1980, but little attention was paid to it. As far as I know, the conclusion has never been contested.

3. Accents and Vowelling in General

Dresher (1994) argues that the accent system has a prosodic basis. Within this, pausal forms mark intonational phrases. Thus far the argument is convincing. However, Dresher goes on to state that the pausal forms which end these intonational phrases are marked by disjunctive accents, which show that the word marked 'is final in its phrase' (Dresher 1994: 3). This is usual, but is not always true. Some 15 pausal forms are marked with conjunctive accents, which, in Dresher's view, show that the word so marked 'is in the same phrase as the word which follows it' (ibid.). Consequently, the assumption that vowels and accents combine harmoniously in the marking of intonational phrases is invalid. This, and other examples, shows that the vowels and the accents of the Masoretic Text do not form a uniform, self-consistent system. Supporting examples are not difficult to find.⁹ Such examples are not numerous — there are only about 15 pausal forms marked with conjunctive accents out of some 7,000. However, these few cases do show that it cannot be assumed, as a matter of course, that the accentuation represents the relationship of words which gave rise to the vowelling.

4. Pausal Forms and Clause Structure

It has also been suggested that pausal forms stand at the end of a clause, or of some other similarly important syntactic structure.¹⁰ This view is generally presented as a supplement to the common view, to be called on where a pausal form is not marked with one of the major accents, *atnah*, *sillug*, or others which may be considered their equivalents, and so also called 'Caesars', or 'pausal accents' (as Ben David 1995: §0.1, 5–7). In fact, however, of the 7,000 or so pausal

⁹ For instance, the inconsistency in the use of *holem* and *qames*, or *sere* and *segol*, in a stressed or unstressed closed final syllable (see Yeivin 1980: §305); the single case of *nesiga* in a word with a disjunctive accent (Num. 23:23); cases of a word with prefixed *waw* with *qames* shown by the accentuation to be separated from the preceding word (e.g., Ps. 10:15, Qoh. 2:23, where the Greek translation treats the words as connected), are all cases in which the vowels and accents reflect different understandings of the passage. See also §14 below.

¹⁰ In this paper, the term 'clause' denotes a simple predicative structure usually composed of a verb and its subject and modifiers, if any. The less common verbless clauses include no verb, but are composed of two other constituents, united by a 'nexus of predication', which is not specifically marked in Biblical Hebrew, but is commonly represented in translations by a form of the verb 'to be'.

forms which occur in the Twenty-one Books, about 85% (over 6,000) stand at the end of a clause.¹¹ The proportion of pausal forms marked with *atnah* and *silluq* is similar, but tends to be somewhat lower.¹² Lesser accents are marked on the remaining pausal forms. Thus pausal forms are marked with *silluq* or *atnah* less frequently than they stand at the end of a clause. Moreover, almost any disjunctive accent may be marked on a pausal form which terminates a clause.¹³ That is to say, the ends of clauses are not marked by particular accents. Occasionally, a pausal form marked with a conjunctive accent terminates a clause. Such cases, and others in which the vowelling is not consistent with the accentuation, are often easily explained as showing that the accentuation and vowelling reflect different understandings of the passage.¹⁴ This range of phenomena clearly confirms the suggestion that the occurrence of a pausal form is not determined by the accent marked on it. It is certainly true that pausal forms occur more commonly with the 'pausal' accents, and less commonly with accents of low status. This is simply because the high status accents are more commonly used to mark the ends of major semantic units. Thus, it is not reasonable to give the accents pride of place above clause structure as the principal cause of the occurrence of pausal forms. Pausal forms delimit the intonational phrases made up of the semantic units of the text. A clause which terminates in a contextual form is shown to be joined in an intonational unit with the following clause, as אָרָץ (Gen. 1:10), קָן (Gen. 4:1), יָדָעְתִּי (Gen. 4:9). Accents mark the music of the chant and merely confirm (in most cases) the delimitation marked by the pausal forms.

¹¹ The numbers given here and elsewhere in this paper are intended for purposes of comparison, to give a general idea of the numbers involved, not a precise count. The figures, and indeed, the list of pausal forms studied here, are derived from the lists published in Revell 2012.

¹² The proportion is highest in the books of the Pentateuch, as in Genesis: *silluq* 43%, *atnah* 40%, in Deuteronomy: s. 38%, a. 35%. In the Former Prophets, the proportion is similar, but in the Latter Prophets, it is lower, as in Isaiah: s. 35%, a. 39%, in the Twelve Prophets: s. 34%, a. 38%.

¹³ Clauses are terminated by pausal forms marked with *silluq* (Gen. 1:20), *atnah* (Gen. 1:5), *segolta* (Gen. 3:17), *šalšelet* (Gen. 19:16), *zaqef* (Gen. 3:17), *revia* (Gen. 28:15), *tišba* (Gen. 3:10), *pašta* (Gen. 27:37), *tevir* (Jer. 9:2), *gereš* (Deut. 24:19), *legarmeh* (Lev. 10:6), *pazer* (2 Kgs 3:25), and *teliša* (Ezek. 20:21). *Zarqa* is occasionally marked on a pausal form (as in 2 Sam. 3:8), but not at the end of a clause.

¹⁴ So Bergsträsser 1962: I, §29a, 160, and see §14 below.

5. Pausal Forms within a Clause

Pausal forms which stand within clauses (a little over 900 in number, some 15% of the total) are used only in a limited range of positions, and are used sporadically rather than regularly. A pausal form is often used at the end of an item, or a group of items, in a list. A pausal form is sometimes used at the end of an 'Introduction to Speech' (ISP, see below §9). Lists and ISPs constitute special situations governed by their own conventions. 'Ordinary' clauses, those which do not include lists or ISPs, are made up from a small number of constituents: a verb, an adverb, an infinitival phrase, a nominal phrase acting as subject, as a term of address (vocative), as modifier, alone, or with an introductory preposition, as a prepositional phrase. Relative clauses are here considered to form part of the same constituent as the noun they modify. Other subordinate clauses are treated as independent. A pausal form within a clause most commonly stands before the terminal constituent. It may also stand at the end of the initial constituent of the clause, or before two or more constituents which end the clause. It rarely appears in other positions. In whichever of the three main positions a pausal form is used, it typically stands at the main division of the clause. That is, it is marked by the accent which marks the main division of the clause. The accent which marks a pausal form within a clause is most commonly *atnah*. *Zaqef* and *tifha* are also frequently used. Many of the other disjunctive accents sometimes mark a pausal form within a clause, although they are less commonly used.¹⁵ The following examples illustrate the way pausal forms are used within clauses.

6. Pause Ending the First Constituent

Pause ending the initial constituent of the clause is relatively rare, occurring in some 75 cases. The initial constituent appears to be isolated from the remainder of the clause by the terminal pausal form, and so to be highlighted, adding to the attention drawn to it by its clause-initial position. The constituent so terminated may be extraposed (may stand outside the clause, and be represented within it, usually by a pronoun). The subject of the clause is most frequently treated in this way, as in 1 Kgs 5:19:

¹⁵ According to my lists, the only disjunctive accents which are not used within a clause are *legarmeh* and *teliša*.

בִּנְךָ אֲשֶׁר אַתָּן תַּחֲתֶיךָ עַל־כִּסְאֶךָ הוּא־יִבְנֶה הַבַּיִת לְשָׁמִי:

Also Lev. 11:12, 1 Kgs 14:19, etc. The object is also sometimes extraposed, as in Exod. 12:44, Num. 30:14. Pause may also be used after an initial constituent which is not extraposed, as a prepositional phrase, in Deut. 9:11, 2 Sam. 8:8, Isa. 33:3, Mic. 7:5, etc., or an initial nominal phrase acting as subject or object, as in Gen. 15:14, Exod. 30:14, Jer. 52:19, 1 Chron. 29:26. A term of address may also be treated in this way, as in 1 Kgs 17:21:

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי תַשֵּׁב נָא נַפְש־הַיֶּלֶד הַזֶּה עַל־קִרְבּוֹ:

Also 1 Kgs 17:20.

7. Pause preceding the Terminal Constituent

A pausal form standing within a clause most commonly precedes the terminal constituent (nearly 400 cases). Pause in this position appears often to end the basic core of the clause, thus isolating, and so drawing attention to, the additional information provided by the terminal constituent. Any constituent may be treated in this way. Cases of pause preceding the terminal constituent of a verbless clause are included in this group, as in Dan. 8:20,

הָאֵיל אֲשֶׁר־רָאִיתָ בְּעַל הַקִּרְנַיִם מֶלֶכִּי מְדִי וּפָרָס:

also in Num 13:8, etc., and, with minor pausal form, Jer. 17:17. The subject of the verbal clause is isolated in this way in Isa. 7:22,

כִּי־חֲמָאָה וַיִּדְבֹּשׁ יֹאכָל כָּל־הַנוֹתָר בְּקֶרֶב הָאָרֶץ:

also in Gen. 46:6, as is the object or other nominal modifier in 2 Sam. 1:1, Isa. 64:3, etc., or a prepositional phrase in Gen. 29:19, 1 Sam. 9:21, 1 Kgs 17:14, Isa. 14:15, 1 Chron. 28:1, etc. A term of address may also be isolated at the end of a clause, as it may at the beginning, as in Gen. 27:34, 38, 1 Kgs 17:18, 2 Chron. 35:21. Finally, although defined above as forming part of the same constituent as the noun it modifies, a relative clause quite often follows a pausal form as the terminal element in a clause, as in Exod. 1:8,

וַיָּקָם מֶלֶךְ־חֲדָשׁ עַל־מִצְרַיִם אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָדַע אֶת־יֹסֵף:

also in 2 Sam. 3:8, Isa. 18:1, Neh. 1:10, etc. Nominal additions to, or modifiers of, constituents are likewise often added at the end of a clause following a pausal form, as in Deut. 4:16, 7:21, 1 Kgs 5:31 etc.

8. Pause Elsewhere within a Clause

Pause within a clause is used in other positions (commonly before two or more constituents which end the clause) in about 150 cases. The constituents following the pausal form in this position are often parallel, suggesting a form of hendiadys — with a single semantic unit presented in several phrases. Consequently, in this case, the pausal form precedes, and isolates, the terminal semantic constituent, rather than a terminal group of syntactic constituents. In a number of cases this embellishes poetic structure, as in Mic. 1:4

וְנִמְסוּ הַהָרִים תַּחֲתָיו וְהָעֵמֶקִים יִתְבַּקְּעוּ כְּדֹנָג מִפְּנֵי הָאֵשׁ כָּמִים מִגֵּרִים בְּמוֹרֵד:

also in Isa. 1:8, 30:2, Song 1:5, etc. Examples are also common enough in prose, as in Gen. 24:11, Exod. 8:1, 1 Kgs 3:13, Isa. 45:13, etc. However, two or more constituents ending a clause after a pausal form often do not present the same idea, as in 2 Kgs 20:17.

הִנֵּה יָמִים בָּאִים וְנִשְׂאָא | כָּל־אֲשֶׁר בְּבֵיתְךָ וְאֲשֶׁר אֶצְרִי אֲבִיתְךָ עַד־הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה בְּכֹלָה

also in Lev. 24:6, Jer. 27:13, Qoh. 11:6, etc.

9. Pause Ending an 'Introduction to Speech'

A Pausal form terminates an introduction to speech in about 150 cases. 'Introduction to speech' (ISP) is the name used here for any structure which stands before and introduces quoted speech.¹⁶ An introductory verb of speaking may stand alone (as in the examples given in note 19 below), or one or more verbs may be used along with other information, providing, for instance, the identities of the speaker and/or the addressee, as in Gen. 4:6.¹⁷ The following speech is here seen as the object of the verb of speaking which introduces it, so that a pausal form terminating the introduction is seen as standing within the clause.¹⁸ A pausal form terminating an ISP typically stands

¹⁶ This term is used in preference to the more usual 'quotative frame' since no 'framework' exists. The end of a speech is typically not marked.

¹⁷ Often a descriptive verb (as וַיֵּצֵן, וַיִּתְּנֵהוּ), is used along with the basic verb of speaking (usually a form of אָמַר or דִּבֶּר).

¹⁸ Ben-David 1995, in the example from 1 Sam. 15:32 given in §0.1.2 (p. 7), states that the noun ending the ISP וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו is pausal in form because it ends a דִּבּוּר (utterance, expression), as is true for אָחֶת, which ends a clause (in the terms used in this paper), in Amos 4:7. However, the words clearly belong to different categories, as some 6,000 (85% of) pausal forms terminate clauses, while only some 150 end introductions to speech, a small proportion of the total possible.

at the main division of the unit formed by the ISP and the first semantic unit of the speech. This unit may include the whole of a short and simple speech, as in 1 Sam. 15:32, Ruth 2:6. The first semantic unit of a speech often itself ends in a pausal form, as in the following examples:

The blessing of Melchizedek in Gen. 14:19

וַיְבָרְכֵהוּ וַיֹּאמֶר בְּרוּךְ אַבְרָם לֹאֵל עֲלִיּוֹן קִנָּה שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ:

Hannah vows to consecrate to the Lord the son (Samuel) for whom she is praying in 1 Sam. 1:11

וַתֵּדֶר נָדָר וַתֹּאמֶר יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אִם־רָאָה תִּרְאֶה | בְּעֵינֵי אִמְתִּי וּזְכַרְתִּי וְלֹא־תִשְׁכַּח
אֶת־אִמְתִּיךָ ...

The Lord prepares the prophet Jeremiah for the duty of delivering a prophecy of doom in Jer. 11:9

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֵלַי נִמְצָא־קֶשֶׁר בְּאִישׁ יְהוּדָה וּבִישָׁבֵי יְרוּשָׁלַם:

An introduction to speech most commonly ends with a contextual or a neutral form. The occasional use of a pausal form appears to mark the speech as particularly important, as in the above examples.¹⁹ Thus, it is clear that the use of a pausal form at the end of an introduction to speech is determined by conventions different from those determining the use of a pausal form within an 'ordinary' clause.

10. Pausal Forms in Typical Lists

Pausal forms terminate items, or units formed of groups of items, which make up a list, in over 100 cases. A list is here defined as a set of successive words, phrases, or clauses, which are used in parallel in that each performs the same function in the clause, or in the wider context in which they stand. Where the items composing the list are

¹⁹ Other examples are provided by the verse-initial pausal form וַיֹּאמֶר which introduces Abraham's polite invitation to the angels in Gen. 18:3, and leads to the promise that a son will be born to him. In Gen. 19:7 the same form introduces Lot's plea to his neighbours not to molest his guests, which forestalls the proposed criminal action. Both events are significant for the biblical narrative. In Gen. 19:2, the contrasting contextual form וַיֹּאמֶר, also verse-initial, introduces Lot's less hospitable invitation to the angels. This resulted in the saving of Lot and his family, an event of limited significance in the biblical story. An introduction to speech which is presented as a verse also marks the following speech as important, as in Exod. 25:1, Lev. 4:1, Num. 2:1, etc.

relatively long, each may terminate in a pausal form, as in 1 Chron. 1:8 and similar passages. Where the items composing the list are relatively short, two or three are usually grouped to form a unit which also typically terminates in a pausal form. Each such unit is occasionally treated as a verse, as in Lev. 14:54–6, Neh. 7:48–9, 55, etc., so the pausal form ending each is marked with *silluq*. More commonly, these lists formed from short items are included within a verse. In this situation, the end of each unit, and so any terminal pausal form, is typically marked with some other disjunctive accent. This provides a sharp contrast with the typical situation of a pausal form used within an ordinary clause, marked, as it is, with the accent marking the main division of the clause. An example where short items are grouped in a list occurs in Deut. 16:14:

וְשִׂמְחָתָּ בַּחֲגֹף אֹתָהּ וּבִנְיָהּ וּבְתֹרְךָ וְעַבְדְּךָ וְאִמְתְּךָ וְהַלְוִי וְהַגֵּר וְהַיִּתּוֹם וְהָאֵלְמָנָה
אֲשֶׁר בְּשַׁעְרֶיךָ:

Similar examples are provided by other lists which begin with the group אֹתָהּ וּבִנְיָהּ וּבְתֹרְךָ (Exod. 20:10, Deut. 5:14, 12:18, 16:11). Other examples, formed from somewhat longer items, occur in Gen. 49:25, Exod. 7:28, Deut. 12:17; also 1 Sam. 22:14:

וּמִי בְּכָל־עַבְדֶּיךָ כְּדֹד נָאֻמָּן וְחֹתֵן הַמֶּלֶךְ וְסֹר אֶל־מִשְׁמַעְתְּךָ וְנֹכֶד בְּבֵיתְךָ:

Lists of names are often arranged so that a pausal form is used only at the main division of a verse, or at its end, and so is marked with *atnah* or *silluq* as in Gen. 10:26. This is also the case with most lists of longer items, as Deut. 28:18–19:

אֲרוּר פְּרִי־בִטְנְךָ וּפְרִי אֲדָמָתְךָ שֹׁגֵר אֶלְפִיךָ וְעֹשֶׂתְרוֹת צֹאנֶךָ: אֲרוּר אֹתָהּ בְּבֹאֲךָ
וְאֲרוּר אֹתָהּ בְּצֵאתְךָ:

also Exod. 21:24–5, Lev. 7:12, Ezra 10:28, etc. However, as most words are neutral forms, so lists, in many cases, contain only scattered pausal forms. These also are likely to be marked with *atnah* or *silluq*, as in 1 Kgs 4:8–9.

11. Pausal Forms in 'Non-Conformist' Lists

The above description covers the most obvious examples of lists. However, there are a few other lists which do not conform to the above patterns. In 1 Kgs 1:26,

וְלִי אֲנִי־עַבְדְּךָ וְלִצְדִּיק הַכֹּהֵן וּלְבִנְיָהּ בִּן־יְהוֹיָדָע וְלִשְׁלֵמָה עַבְדְּךָ לֹא קָרָא:

the first item in the list ends with a pausal form, the second and third items end with neutral forms, and the fourth and final item ends with a contextual form.²⁰ There is a similar situation in the list of three items in 1 Kgs 20:25. The final clause in Exod. 20:17 (cf. Deut. 5:21) appears to be of the same type, although the final item ends with a pausal form.

לֹא תִחַמְדּוּ בֵּית רֶעֶךָ לֹא-תִחַמְדּוּ אִשֶּׁת רֶעֶךָ וְעַבְדּוֹ וְאִמָּתוֹ וְשׁוֹרֹ וְחֲמֹרֹ וְכָל אֲשֶׁר
לְרֶעֶךָ:

As these examples suggest, the convention, in these 'non-conformist' lists, appears to be that the first item in the list ends with a pausal or neutral form. This form is typically (cf. n. 20) marked with an accent which marks the main division of a unit comprising the complete list, or the initial section of it (semantically defined).²¹ This first item is also typically the most important in the list, and can sometimes be considered as comprehending all items listed (as in Deut. 30:9). Items following the first in the list, including the last, may end with a neutral, pausal or contextual form. This convention appears to be followed in the lists named above, and also in Gen. 17:12, Deut. 8:7, 9:1, 11:14, 30:9, Isa. 28:2, and also 2 Kgs 19:13, assuming that the last two words in the verse are not part of the list of kings. This description also applies to the list in Deut. 6:7 and 11:19, where the first item ends with the pausal form בְּבִיתְךָ. The two following items end with contextual forms, but the fourth and last item is the pausal form, וּבְקִוְיָךְ. The accents present items in these lists in two contrasting pairs, and so present the list in a conventional form, contrasting with the vowelling (see §14). There is a similar case in Deut. 30:9, although there the list does not end with a pausal form.

12. Pause in the Three 'Poetical' Books

The general description of the use of pausal forms in the Twenty-one Books, and so these conclusions, is also valid for their use in the

²⁰ This is marked with *tifha*, which marks the main division of the clause, so that the accentuation is not consistent with the vowelling. The initial pausal form, marked with the accent *tešā*, may mark what was originally the main division. I doubt if Ben-David (1995: §0.1.1, 5–6) is right in suggesting that וְלִי אֲנִי עַבְדְּךָ is to be considered a separate clause. It is simply an item in a list, similar to אֶתָּה וּבְנֵי-וְבָתְּךָ (Exod. 20:10), which is also an item in a list ending in a pausal form marked with *tešā*.

²¹ E.g., in Exod. 20:17, Deut. 5:21, the accent *revia* marks the main division of the section of the list ending וְחֲמֹרֹ. This section covers individual items; the concluding section is general and comprehensive.

Three 'Poetical' books: Psalms, Job, Proverbs. However, the Three Books are composed in relatively short clauses, which provide, at their ends, more frequent opportunity for the use of pausal forms than do the longer clauses of the Twenty-one Books. On the other hand, the use of pausal forms within clauses in the Three Books is correspondingly reduced.²² Less than one in ten of the more than 2,250 pausal forms in the Three Books is used within a clause. The use of pausal forms within clauses in the poetical books follows the same general pattern as it does in the prose books, but clause structure in the poetical books is more varied, so that the description of the positions in which pausal forms are used within clauses in the prose books would need to be considerably expanded to cover their use in the poetical books adequately. However, the notable fact that a pausal form within a clause typically stands at the main division of the clause is equally valid in both, as is shown for the Three Books by the common examples where a pausal form within a clause is marked with the accent marking the main division of the verse: 'Oleh weyored, as in Ps. 56:14, Job 32:6 etc., or *atnah*, as in Ps. 2:2, Job 4:6, Prov. 1:17 etc., or even *revia* (*mugra*) as in Ps. 128:4:

הִנֵּה כִּי־כֵן יִבְרַךְ גִּבּוֹר יְרֵא יְהוָה:

Also Job 33:24. If *atnah* does not stand at the main division of a verse, it may, even so, mark a pausal form at the main division of a clause, as in Ps. 22:15:

כַּמִּים נִשְׁפַּכְתִּי וְהִתְפַּרְדּוּ כָל־עֲצָמוֹתַי הִיָּה לִבִּי כְדוֹנָג נִמַּס בְּתוֹךְ מַעֲי:

Other accents, of course, may also mark the main division of a clause, as *sinnor* in Job 7:20:

חָטָאתִי מֶה אֶפְעַל | לִךְ נֹצַר הָאָדָם

Also Ps. 79:13. *Dehi* can also be used in this way, as in Ps. 45:2, 66:15.

Occasionally, a pausal form is marked with a conjunctive accent. In the Three Books, this seems mainly due to carelessness.²³ In any

²² This tendency is also visible in the latter prophets, where the 200 cases of pause within a clause form a much smaller proportion of the total pausal forms (about 10% of over 2,000) than do those in the Torah (329 of 1850, about 17%) and Former Prophets (183 of 1250 about 13%), or those in the prose writings (220 of 739, about 29%).

²³ As with *למשפטך* (with *munah* Ps. 119:43), *כמשפטך* (with *merka*, Ps. 119:149), probably due to the defective writing of a plural noun. In Ps. 93:1, the pointing of *לְבַשׁ* (with *munah*) may be influenced by the preceding *לְבַשׁ* (with 'Oleh weyored), which ends a clause. In Prov. 25:3 *וְאֶרֶץ* (with *munah*), though separated by one

case, these forms, if correctly identified as pausal, most probably only reflect the fact that, when the accentuation was fixed in the text, pausal forms had come to be regarded as undetermined variations of the contextual form (see n. 29 below).

13. Pause Marking Several Divisions in a Clause

In the discussion of the material in the Twenty-one Books, it was suggested that all pausal forms within ordinary clauses stand at the main division of the clause, but this is not entirely correct. A small proportion of them mark other divisions. For example, in Ezek. 44:5, the pausal form *שָׁמַע* is marked with *revia*, which marks it as the main divider of the core of the clause (free of the terminal prepositional phrases), which ends with the pausal form *אֶתְּךָ*, marked with *zaqef*. This word marks the main division of the complete clause, which extends to *תּוֹרָתוֹ*, marked with *atnah*. Thus the pausal forms divide this clause into three parts. The same is true in 2 Sam. 24:13, in a clause composed of a verb and a prepositional modifier, followed by three nominal phrases presenting alternative questions, each of which ends with a pausal form. The first of these forms, *בְּאַרְצֶךָ*, is marked with *pazer*, which marks it as the main divider of the unit ending with the second pausal form, *רִדְפְּךָ*. This word is marked with *revia*, which shows it to be the main divider of the unit ending with the third pausal form, again *בְּאַרְצֶךָ*, which is marked with *zaqef*, and ends the clause. However, most words do not appear in contrasting pausal and contextual forms. In several cases a pausal form which does not stand at the main division of a clause can be assumed to show that that clause was divided into more than two sections. For example, *רָכַשׁ* (Gen. 31:18) is marked with *zaqef*, as the main divider of the unit ending *אֶרֶם* marked with *atnah*, whereas the clause ends with *כְּנָעַן* marked with *silluq*. Presumably the clause was also divided at *אֶרֶם*, although that word, being a neutral form, could not mark the division. Similar cases occur in Gen. 17:7 *וּבְיִנֶּךָ*, and in Jer. 22:25 *נִפְשֶׁךָ*, which both mark the main division of the *atnah* unit, in a clause which continues for the whole verse. There is some reason to suppose

word from the preceding *שָׁמַע* may have been influenced by the common pair *שָׁמַע וְאַרְץ*. In this case, and the similar one in Isa. 65:17, the word is marked with a conjunctive accent, which is unusual. A word with prefixed *waw* with *qames* is typically marked with a disjunctive accent, as is the even more surprising use of *וְאַרְץ* in Isa. 26:19. These three cases can only be treated as anomalies, as was already recognized by the Masoretes.

that, occasionally, a clause may have been divided into more than three parts. In Dan. 9:24, קִדְשָׁךְ, marked with *revia*, marks the main division of the unit ending עֲוֹן, which is marked with *zaqef*. If pause was used at this *zaqef*, and also at the following *atnah*, the clause would have been divided into four parts. Pausal forms do not, however, always suggest neat divisions of a verse. In Deut. 30:9, יִדְּךָ marked with *revia*, should mark the main division of the unit ending אֲדַמְתֶּךָ which is marked with *tifha*; however the clause ends with the following word, which is marked with *atnah*. There is a similar case in 2 Kgs 20:17 (see §8) and in Isa. 39:6. This phenomenon of subdivision of semantic units is not restricted to clauses. The introduction to speech in Isa. 44:24 ends with the pausal form מִבְּטֶן but the unit is divided internally by the pausal form גִּאֲלֶךָ. There is a similar case in Ezek. 44:6, where the ISP ends with the neutral form יִשְׂרָאֵל but is divided by the pausal form מִרִּי. Similarly, the initial constituent of a clause is occasionally divided by a pausal form, as in Lev. 18:9. These cases support the conclusion that, as in verses, in long or complex semantic units, most of which are clauses, divisions are marked by pausal forms not only at the main division in the unit, but also in other positions rendered suitable by the semantic structure of the passage.

14. Vowels and Accents Representing Different Understandings of a Verse

A small number of pausal forms which are not marked with the accent marking the main division of a clause, appear to represent cases in which vowelling and accentuation reflect different understandings of the passage.²⁴ For example, the two cases in which a conjunctive accent is marked on a pausal form terminating a protasis in Mal. 1:6

וְאִם־אֵבֶן אֲנִי אִיהָ כְּבוֹדִי וְאִם־אֲדוֹנִים אֲנִי אִיהָ מוֹרָאִי

The vowelling here presumably reflects a tradition in which each of the two protases was treated as an independent clause which was followed by an apodosis.²⁵ The structure of the passage as composed of

²⁴ An example has been given above in n. 20 to §11. This phenomenon is not restricted to pausal forms, but is also reflected in other situations in which the accents are not consistent with the vowelling. See n. 9 to §3.

²⁵ A protasis is terminated by a pausal form in some 50 other cases, as Gen. 31:52, Exod. 7:27, Lev. 2:7, Num. 14:28, Deut. 20:12, etc. For Ben-David, the vowelling of אֲנִי in Mal. 1:6 is due to the preceding predicate (1995: 88, §5), whereas אִם־אֲנִי

two conditional sentences was thus highlighted, emphasizing the question of whether the speaker is, in fact, a 'father' or a 'Lord'. The accentuation reflects a tradition in which the two conditional sentences were each treated as an undivided unit. This highlights the value of the passage as presenting two questions, emphasizing the problem of whether the speaker was in fact treated as 'father' or 'Lord'. This change accounts for the use of a conjunctive accent to mark the pausal forms.²⁶ Such treatment implies that pausal and contextual forms were treated as unconditioned variants (see n. 29 below). Change in the understanding of the passage also appears to have occurred in the list in Deut. 6:7 and 11:19. This has been treated as an example of a 'non-conformist' style of list in §11 above, as suggested by the vowelling. In contrast, the accentuation presents it as a typical list of short items grouped in pairs, so that **בְּכִיתָךְ**, which is marked with *pašta*, is expected to show a contextual form, and **בְּדָרְךָ**, marked with *zaqef*, to which the *pašta* is subordinate, is expected to show a pausal form (as noted in Ben-David 1995: §0.0.0, 1). A similar inconsistency appears to occur in Deut. 18:4, where **צִאָּנְךָ**, marked with *tifha*, which marks the main division of the verse and the clause in terms of the accents, is a contextual form, while the preceding **וְיִצְהָרְךָ**, marked with *revia* subordinate to the *tifha*, is pausal in form. It seems quite probable that **וְיִצְהָרְךָ**, rather than **צִאָּנְךָ**, marked the main division of the verse when the vowelling was fixed.²⁷ Another similar case occurs in Deut. 15:11, where the pausal form **לְעִנִּיךָ** is marked with *tevir*, whereas the following **וְלֹאֲבִינְךָ**, marked with *tifha*, to which the *tevir* is subordinate, is contextual in form. Possibly, **לְעִנִּיךָ** was considered the main division of the clause when the vowelling was fixed.²⁸ In Exod. 10:4, the marking of *munah* on the pausal form **לְשִׁלַּח** has been explained by Ben-David as due to

and **וְאִם־אֵתָהּ** (showing 'minor' pause) in Gen. 31:52 are incomplete clauses (ibid. p. 105, n. 224).

²⁶ Other examples of pausal forms marked with conjunctive accents are discussed in Revell 2011.

²⁷ So Breuer 1992: 225. Geiger 2005: 103 suggests that the pointing in this case was not conditioned by the accents, but was influenced by the four other uses of the same words (Deut. 7:13, 11:14, 12:17, 14:23). Ben-David 1995: 74, n. 126, points out that **יִצְהָרְךָ**, in contextual form, does not occur. It should, however, be noted, that, in all five cases, the pausal form of this word stands at the end of a unit in a list, where pause is to be expected.

²⁸ Ben-David argues (1995: §1.5.1.1, 67) that **לְעִנִּיךָ** is, itself, contextual in form. However, the understanding of this form as pausal is compatible with the structure of the feminine form **עֲנִיָּה** (Isa. 54:11, etc.), so it seems unlikely that Ben-David is correct.

an addition to the text made after the vowelling had been fixed.²⁹ Another possibility is that it derives from a form of tradition in which it (rather than the contextual form **אָתָּה** as marked by the accents) stood at the main division of the clause. A similar case occurs in **שָׁפֶט אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל** (1 Sam. 7:17). The pausal form of **שָׁפֶט** may reflect a tradition in which this word, and not the preceding adverb **שָׁם**, stood at the main division of the clause.³⁰ These cases would then each provide a typical example of a pausal form, marked by the accent marking the main division of the clause, standing before the final constituent of the clause. In Deut. 4:26 the apparently pausal form **תִּאבְדֶּוּן** might possibly show that the clause was divided into more than two sections. I can suggest no explanation for the use of the similar form **יִשְׁאָלֶיךָ** in Jos. 4:6 and 4:21.

15. Pausal Forms in Clauses and Verses

It seems clear that the use of a pausal form within an ordinary clause is related to the use of such a form within a verse. Indeed, the two are often identical, as in Gen. 11:1, Deut. 6:9, 1 Chron. 29:26, etc. The pausal form typically marks the main division in the clause, just as it usually does in a verse. The pausal form marking the main division of an ordinary clause may be marked with a variety of accents, but most commonly a strong accent is used: *atnah*, *zagef*, or *tifha*, accents which also mark a pausal form at the main division of a verse. However, a pausal form marking the main division of a clause may be marked with some other disjunctive accent. This makes it clear that the occurrence of a pausal form is not determined by the individual accent marked on it, but by its position in the language of the text. It is determined by the fact that it ends, or marks the main division of, a significant semantic or syntactic unit. A word does not appear in pausal form because it is marked by *atnah* or

²⁹ Ben-David 1995: §2.3.1.6.2, n. 24 (p. 132) suggests that the words **אֶת־עַמִּי** were added to wording copied, complete with vowelling, from Exod. 7:27, 9:2. This addition necessitated a change in the accentuation. As a result, the (accentual) word **אֶת־עַמִּי** is marked with *atnah*, and the preceding pausal form **לִשְׁלַח** with a conjunctive. This would imply that the significance of the pausal form was not recognized; it was regarded as simply a chance variant of the contextual form.

³⁰ Ben-David 1995: §2.4.1.3 (p.138) suggests that the pausal vowelling of **שָׁפֶט** was introduced to avoid cacophony, citing the note to G.K. §29i in support. That note, however, ignores the fact that the words **שָׁפֶט אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל**, with the same verb in contextual form and with a conjunctive accent, occur in Judg. 16:31 and 1 Sam. 4:18.

silluq, but because it stands at the main division of a verse, or at its end. The same is true of any other accent with pausal forms in other positions. These pausal forms stand at the end of a clause, or at its main division, or occasionally at some other significant break within a clause (as described in §13). The accents with which they are marked are chosen according to the conventions of the accent system, based on the understanding of the passage at the time of their introduction. It can be argued that where a pausal form ends an ISP, or is used to mark one of two or more divisions in a clause, the pausal form can still be seen as marking the main division of a semantic unit, as shown in §13. That unit may not be a clause in terms of syntax, but this is also true of many verses. This suggests that the divisions marked by pausal forms also mark a form of 'dichotomy', imperfect though it might be, in much the same way as do the accents. That is, pausal forms have no relationship with the individual accents marked in the biblical text, but they do, in fact, mark basic structures in the same or a similar way as does the accentuation.

16. All Pausal Forms are Equally Significant

This survey has shown that the system of pausal forms is not simply a matter of their significant regular use when marked with strong accents, such as *silluq* and *atnah*, and their occasional, relatively unimportant, use elsewhere. In fact, pausal forms are used in a regular way, at the main division of a semantic unit, and at its end, in almost all cases. Thus, a pausal form is used at the end of a clause, unless that clause forms a semantic unit with one or more other clauses. It may also be used at the main division of a clause, and occasionally elsewhere within it. The use of pausal forms within clauses is sporadic in that it fails to occur in many clauses, but is regular in that (with rare exceptions), the pausal form is used at the main division of the clause, or to end some other significant semantic unit. It may not be obvious why a pausal form is used at the main division of one clause but not that of another, but this is also true of the use of pausal forms at the main division of a verse which does not use *atnah*,³¹ and, indeed, why the main division of one verse is marked with *tifha* and that of another

³¹ Most accents marking the main division of a verse in which *atnah* is not used are marked on neutral forms. The few pausal and contextual forms marked with *tifha* or *zaqef* where one of these is the main divider of the verse are listed in Geiger 2005: §3.2–3, 99–104.

with *atnah*.³² I assume that such questions could be answered only after a comprehensive study of the basis of the division of the text into verses, and into smaller units within the verses. The above discussion has shown quite clearly that the occurrence of pausal forms in a passage is determined by syntactic and semantic units of which the passage is composed. The relation of these forms to the accents is determined simply by the choice of accents used to delimit these units.

17. Conclusion

This survey can, then, conclude that the occurrence of pausal forms is not determined by the accents which mark them, but by the syntactic, or, more properly, the semantic structure of the text. Most pausal forms stand at the end of a clause. A proportion stand at the main division, or, occasionally, also at subsidiary divisions of a clause. These positions account not only for the greater number of pausal forms, which are marked with *sillug* and *atnah*, but also for the others, no less important, which may be marked with any other disjunctive accent. Pausal forms, then, mark the end and the middle of clauses in much the same way as they do the ends and middle of verses, and so can be said to mark the so-called dichotomy much as do the accents. This suggests that the tendency to mark 'dichotomy' was a feature of the Hebrew language, not simply of the biblical chant. It also suggests that the vowelling, or, some features of it, was fixed in the text before the accentuation. This is not to suggest that minor details of either system, such as conjunctive accents, and composite or simple *shewas*, were all fixed in place at this time, but simply that pausal forms delimiting the basic units of the text were fixed in place before the accentuation was introduced. It seems most likely that, although the pausal forms were preserved in the traditional vowelling when the accents were introduced, they were regarded, by that time, simply as free variants of the contextual forms. This is shown by the marking of some forms with conjunctive accents, or other accents inconsistent with the pausal vowelling (see §14 and n. 29). If the accentuation was in place first, and conditioned the vowelling, as is commonly supposed, the vowelling should be consistent with the accentuation. This is often not the case (see §3 and n. 9). It does not seem possible that such inconsistency should have occurred if the vowelling were fixed

³² See Geiger 2005: 99. Wickes describes the choice, in certain cases, as 'entirely optional' (1887: 63).

after the accentuation was in place, and determined the presentation of the text.

Address for Correspondence: ejrevell@eastlink.ca
48 Whidden Street, Antigonish NS, Canada B2G 2Z2

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THE OCCURRENCE OF PAUSAL FORMS

E.J. REVELL

UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO

Abstract

The common opinion maintains that the accents determine the occurrence of pausal forms, despite various problems with this view. E.g. any disjunctive accent may be marked on a pausal form, and a few conjunctives are also so marked. Moreover, it is easy to find both contextual and pausal forms of a word marked with the same accent. Syntactic (or more correctly, semantic) structure provides a solid theoretical base for the development of pausal forms than do the accents, a base with fewer problems. The vast majority of pausal forms stand at the end of a clause. The remainder (some 15%) stand within a clause in equally standardized positions, mostly at the main division of the clause as marked by the accents. Consequently, it should be agreed that the occurrence of pausal forms is determined by the syntactic/semantic units making up the text.

1. Pausal, Contextual and Neutral Forms

A pausal form is a form of a word used in particular positions, which differs in features of vowel pattern and/or stress position from the (generally) more common contextual form which is used in other positions.¹ Most words do not form contrasting pausal and contextual forms. Such words are referred to here as 'neutral' forms. A few words produce two different pausal forms contrasting with the contextual form: a 'full' pausal form which shows the full difference from the contextual form both in vowel pattern and in stress position, and a 'minor' pausal form which typically shows the pausal stress position, but the contextual vowel pattern.²

¹ The ways in which pausal forms differ from contextual are described briefly in Joüon and Muraoka 1993, in greater detail in Goerwitz 1993 and in Qimron 2008, and, with even more detail, but an unusually wide understanding of the term 'pausal form', in Ben David 1995.

² It appears that a minor pausal form reveals the pausal stress pattern induced by the position in which it stands, but that this position has not affected the vowel pattern as has occurred in the 'full' pausal form.

2. Accents and Pausal Forms

This paper is mainly concerned with the twenty-one 'prose' books of the Masoretic Text of the Hebrew Bible.³ There are different opinions on the reasons why pausal forms are generated in the particular positions in which they occur in these books. The most common view attributes the occurrence of a pausal form to the accent with which it is marked.⁴ I assume that this view derives directly from the simplified description commonly used in earlier times: pausal forms occur with *atnah* and *silluq* and sometimes with *zaqef*. However, attention to the details of the text shows clearly that this is simply a generalization. It ignores details important for the understanding of the occurrence of pausal forms.

Atnah and *Silluq* are regularly marked on Pausal forms, but also occasionally appear on contextual forms.⁵

Any disjunctive accent may be marked on a pausal form: see note 13, below. Conjunctive accents are also sporadically marked on such forms.

It is easy enough to find the same accent marked either on the pausal form, or on the contextual form, of the same word.⁶ Thus *zaqef* is often marked on the pausal form וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 18:29, 20:4, 28:17, etc., and on the corresponding contextual form וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 3:11, 9:26, Exod. 4:1, etc. Some explanation of these problems is needed if the view that pausal forms are induced by individual accents is to be maintained.⁷ This has not been provided. Consequently it is assumed here that no pausal form is induced by the accent which is marked on it.⁸

³ The Leningrad codex is followed, with chapter and verse divisions as in BHS.

⁴ See e.g. Blau 1976: §11.1, 39; Bergsträsser 1962: I §29a; Ben-David 1995: §0.1.1, 5 and *passim*.

⁵ The cases of *atnah* and *silluq* marked on contextual forms are listed in Geiger 2005: §3.1, 96–9.

⁶ This phenomenon is noted in Bergsträsser 1962: I, §29a, 160. Ben-David 1995: §0.1.1–2, 5–7, correctly explains some such usage with reference to syntax. However he does not consider cases in which there is no obvious syntactic difference, as with וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 3:10, 11, and וַיֵּאמֶר in Gen. 33:5.

⁷ Geiger (2005: §1, 59–61) accepts that most accents do not induce pausal forms, but argues that *atnah* and *silluq* do do this. However, as far as I know, no attempt has ever been made to demonstrate (rather than simply to state) that the accent marked on the word induces the pausal form; i.e. to show that pausal forms are a feature of the chant, not of the language. *Atnah* and *silluq*, like other accents, represent tropes in the music to which the text was chanted, so there is no reasonable basis for treating them separately.

⁸ The same conclusion was put forward in Revell 1980, but little attention was paid to it. As far as I know, the conclusion has never been contested.

3. Accents and Vowelling in General

Dresher (1994) argues that the accent system has a prosodic basis. Within this, pausal forms mark intonational phrases. Thus far the argument is convincing. However, Dresher goes on to state that the pausal forms which end these intonational phrases are marked by disjunctive accents, which show that the word marked 'is final in its phrase' (Dresher 1994: 3). This is usual, but is not always true. Some 15 pausal forms are marked with conjunctive accents, which, in Dresher's view, show that the word so marked 'is in the same phrase as the word which follows it' (ibid.). Consequently, the assumption that vowels and accents combine harmoniously in the marking of intonational phrases is invalid. This, and other examples, shows that the vowels and the accents of the Masoretic Text do not form a uniform, self-consistent system. Supporting examples are not difficult to find.⁹ Such examples are not numerous — there are only about 15 pausal forms marked with conjunctive accents out of some 7,000. However, these few cases do show that it cannot be assumed, as a matter of course, that the accentuation represents the relationship of words which gave rise to the vowelling.

4. Pausal Forms and Clause Structure

It has also been suggested that pausal forms stand at the end of a clause, or of some other similarly important syntactic structure.¹⁰ This view is generally presented as a supplement to the common view, to be called on where a pausal form is not marked with one of the major accents, *atnah*, *silluq*, or others which may be considered their equivalents, and so also called 'Caesars', or 'pausal accents' (as Ben David 1995: §0.1, 5–7). In fact, however, of the 7,000 or so pausal

⁹ For instance, the inconsistency in the use of *holem* and *qames*, or *šere* and *segol*, in a stressed or unstressed closed final syllable (see Yeivin 1980: §305); the single case of *nesiga* in a word with a disjunctive accent (Num. 23:23); cases of a word with prefixed *waw* with *qames* shown by the accentuation to be separated from the preceding word (e.g., Ps. 10:15, Qoh. 2:23, where the Greek translation treats the words as connected), are all cases in which the vowels and accents reflect different understandings of the passage. See also §14 below.

¹⁰ In this paper, the term 'clause' denotes a simple predicative structure usually composed of a verb and its subject and modifiers, if any. The less common verbless clauses include no verb, but are composed of two other constituents, united by a 'nexus of predication', which is not specifically marked in Biblical Hebrew, but is commonly represented in translations by a form of the verb 'to be'.

forms which occur in the Twenty-one Books, about 85% (over 6,000) stand at the end of a clause.¹¹ The proportion of pausal forms marked with *atnah* and *silluq* is similar, but tends to be somewhat lower.¹² Lesser accents are marked on the remaining pausal forms. Thus pausal forms are marked with *silluq* or *atnah* less frequently than they stand at the end of a clause. Moreover, almost any disjunctive accent may be marked on a pausal form which terminates a clause.¹³ That is to say, the ends of clauses are not marked by particular accents. Occasionally, a pausal form marked with a conjunctive accent terminates a clause. Such cases, and others in which the vowelings is not consistent with the accentuation, are often easily explained as showing that the accentuation and vowelings reflect different understandings of the passage.¹⁴ This range of phenomena clearly confirms the suggestion that the occurrence of a pausal form is not determined by the accent marked on it. It is certainly true that pausal forms occur more commonly with the 'pausal' accents, and less commonly with accents of low status. This is simply because the high status accents are more commonly used to mark the ends of major semantic units. Thus, it is not reasonable to give the accents pride of place above clause structure as the principal cause of the occurrence of pausal forms. Pausal forms delimit the intonational phrases made up of the semantic units of the text. A clause which terminates in a contextual form is shown to be joined in an intonational unit with the following clause, as אָרָץ (Gen. 1:10), קָיָן (Gen. 4:1), יִדְעָתִי (Gen. 4:9). Accents mark the music of the chant and merely confirm (in most cases) the delimitation marked by the pausal forms.

¹¹ The numbers given here and elsewhere in this paper are intended for purposes of comparison, to give a general idea of the numbers involved, not a precise count. The figures, and indeed, the list of pausal forms studied here, are derived from the lists published in Revell 2012.

¹² The proportion is highest in the books of the Pentateuch, as in Genesis: *s(illuq)* 43%, *a(tnah)* 40%, in Deuteronomy: s. 38%, a. 35%. In the Former Prophets, the proportion is similar, but in the Latter Prophets, it is lower, as in Isaiah: s. 35%, a. 39%, in the Twelve Prophets: s. 34%, a. 38%.

¹³ Clauses are terminated by pausal forms marked with *silluq* (Gen. 1:20), *atnah* (Gen. 1:5), *segolta* (Gen. 3:17), *šalselet* (Gen. 19:16), *zaqef* (Gen. 3:17), *revia* (Gen. 28:15), *tifha* (Gen. 3:10), *paša* (Gen. 27:37), *tevir* (Jer. 9:2), *gereš* (Deut. 24:19), *legarmeh* (Lev. 10:6), *pazer* (2 Kgs 3:25), and *teliša* (Ezek. 20:21). *Zarqa* is occasionally marked on a pausal form (as in 2 Sam. 3:8), but not at the end of a clause.

¹⁴ So Bergsträsser 1962: I, §29a, 160, and see §14 below.

5. Pausal Forms within a Clause

Pausal forms which stand within clauses (a little over 900 in number, some 15% of the total) are used only in a limited range of positions, and are used sporadically rather than regularly. A pausal form is often used at the end of an item, or a group of items, in a list. A pausal form is sometimes used at the end of an 'Introduction to Speech' (ISP, see below §9). Lists and ISPs constitute special situations governed by their own conventions. 'Ordinary' clauses, those which do not include lists or ISPs, are made up from a small number of constituents: a verb, an adverb, an infinitival phrase, a nominal phrase acting as subject, as a term of address (vocative), as modifier, alone, or with an introductory preposition, as a prepositional phrase. Relative clauses are here considered to form part of the same constituent as the noun they modify. Other subordinate clauses are treated as independent. A pausal form within a clause most commonly stands before the terminal constituent. It may also stand at the end of the initial constituent of the clause, or before two or more constituents which end the clause. It rarely appears in other positions. In whichever of the three main positions a pausal form is used, it typically stands at the main division of the clause. That is, it is marked by the accent which marks the main division of the clause. The accent which marks a pausal form within a clause is most commonly *atnah*. *Zaqef* and *tifha* are also frequently used. Many of the other disjunctive accents sometimes mark a pausal form within a clause, although they are less commonly used.¹⁵ The following examples illustrate the way pausal forms are used within clauses.

6. Pause Ending the First Constituent

Pause ending the initial constituent of the clause is relatively rare, occurring in some 75 cases. The initial constituent appears to be isolated from the remainder of the clause by the terminal pausal form, and so to be highlighted, adding to the attention drawn to it by its clause-initial position. The constituent so terminated may be extraposed (may stand outside the clause, and be represented within it, usually by a pronoun). The subject of the clause is most frequently treated in this way, as in 1 Kgs 5:19:

¹⁵ According to my lists, the only disjunctive accents which are not used within a clause are *legarmeh* and *teliša*.

בָּנָה אֲשֶׁר אֶתֶן תַּחְתִּיד עַל־כִּסְאָהּ הוּא־יִבְנֶה הַבַּיִת לַשָּׁמַיִם:

Also Lev. 11:12, 1 Kgs 14:19, etc. The object is also sometimes extraposed, as in Exod. 12:44, Num. 30:14. Pause may also be used after an initial constituent which is not extraposed, as a prepositional phrase, in Deut. 9:11, 2 Sam. 8:8, Isa. 33:3, Mic. 7:5, etc., or an initial nominal phrase acting as subject or object, as in Gen. 15:14, Exod. 30:14, Jer. 52:19, 1 Chron. 29:26. A term of address may also be treated in this way, as in 1 Kgs 17:21:

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי תַשָּׁב נָא נַפְש־הַיֶּלֶד הַזֶּה עַל־קִרְבּוֹ:

Also 1 Kgs 17:20.

7. Pause preceding the Terminal Constituent

A pausal form standing within a clause most commonly precedes the terminal constituent (nearly 400 cases). Pause in this position appears often to end the basic core of the clause, thus isolating, and so drawing attention to, the additional information provided by the terminal constituent. Any constituent may be treated in this way. Cases of pause preceding the terminal constituent of a verbless clause are included in this group, as in Dan. 8:20,

הָאֵיל אֲשֶׁר־רָאִיתָ בְּעַל הַקִּרְנַיִם מַלְכֵי מְדֵי וּפְרָס:

also in Num 13:8, etc., and, with minor pausal form, Jer. 17:17. The subject of the verbal clause is isolated in this way in Isa. 7:22,

כִּי־חֲמָאָה וּדְבַשׁ יֵאָכַל כָּל־הַנּוֹתָר בְּקִרְבַּי הָאָרֶץ:

also in Gen. 46:6, as is the object or other nominal modifier in 2 Sam. 1:1, Isa. 64:3, etc., or a prepositional phrase in Gen. 29:19, 1 Sam. 9:21, 1 Kgs 17:14, Isa. 14:15, 1 Chron. 28:1, etc. A term of address may also be isolated at the end of a clause, as it may at the beginning, as in Gen. 27:34, 38, 1 Kgs 17:18, 2 Chron. 35:21. Finally, although defined above as forming part of the same constituent as the noun it modifies, a relative clause quite often follows a pausal form as the terminal element in a clause, as in Exod. 1:8,

וַיָּקָם מֶלֶךְ־חֹדֶשׁ עַל־מִצְרַיִם אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָדַע אֶת־יֹסֵף:

also in 2 Sam. 3:8, Isa. 18:1, Neh. 1:10, etc. Nominal additions to, or modifiers of, constituents are likewise often added at the end of a clause following a pausal form, as in Deut. 4:16, 7:21, 1 Kgs 5:31 etc.

8. Pause Elsewhere within a Clause

Pause within a clause is used in other positions (commonly before two or more constituents which end the clause) in about 150 cases. The constituents following the pausal form in this position are often parallel, suggesting a form of hendiadys — with a single semantic unit presented in several phrases. Consequently, in this case, the pausal form precedes, and isolates, the terminal semantic constituent, rather than a terminal group of syntactic constituents. In a number of cases this embellishes poetic structure, as in Mic. 1:4

וְנִמְסוּ הַהָרִים תַּחֲתָיו וְהָעֵמֶקִים יִתְבַּקְּעוּ כְּדֹנַג מִפְּנֵי הָאֵשׁ כְּמִים מִגְרִים בְּמֹרֶד:

also in Isa. 1:8, 30:2, Song 1:5, etc. Examples are also common enough in prose, as in Gen. 24:11, Exod. 8:1, 1 Kgs 3:13, Isa. 45:13, etc. However, two or more constituents ending a clause after a pausal form often do not present the same idea, as in 2 Kgs 20:17.

הִנֵּה יָמִים בָּאִים וְנֹשָׂא | כָּל-אֲשֶׁר בְּבֵיתְךָ וְאֲשֶׁר אֶצְרִי אֲבִיתְךָ עַד-הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה בְּכֹלָה

also in Lev. 24:6, Jer. 27:13, Qoh. 11:6, etc.

9. Pause Ending an 'Introduction to Speech'

A Pausal form terminates an introduction to speech in about 150 cases. 'Introduction to speech' (ISP) is the name used here for any structure which stands before and introduces quoted speech.¹⁶ An introductory verb of speaking may stand alone (as in the examples given in note 19 below), or one or more verbs may be used along with other information, providing, for instance, the identities of the speaker and/or the addressee, as in Gen. 4:6.¹⁷ The following speech is here seen as the object of the verb of speaking which introduces it, so that a pausal form terminating the introduction is seen as standing within the clause.¹⁸ A pausal form terminating an ISP typically stands

¹⁶ This term is used in preference to the more usual 'quotative frame' since no 'framework' exists. The end of a speech is typically not marked.

¹⁷ Often a descriptive verb (as וַיֹּדֶר, וַיֵּצֵן), is used along with the basic verb of speaking (usually a form of אָמַר or דִּבֶּר).

¹⁸ Ben-David 1995, in the example from 1 Sam. 15:32 given in §0.1.2 (p. 7), states that the noun ending the ISP וַיֹּאמֶר אֱנִי is pausal in form because it ends a דִּבְרוֹר (utterance, expression), as is true for אָחַת, which ends a clause (in the terms used in this paper), in Amos 4:7. However, the words clearly belong to different categories, as some 6,000 (85% of) pausal forms terminate clauses, while only some 150 end introductions to speech, a small proportion of the total possible.

at the main division of the unit formed by the ISP and the first semantic unit of the speech. This unit may include the whole of a short and simple speech, as in 1 Sam. 15:32, Ruth 2:6. The first semantic unit of a speech often itself ends in a pausal form, as in the following examples:

The blessing of Melchizedek in Gen. 14:19

וַיְבָרְכֵהוּ וַיֹּאמֶר בְּרוּךְ אַבְרָם לֵאלֹהֵי עֶלְיוֹן קִנְה שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ:

Hannah vows to consecrate to the Lord the son (Samuel) for whom she is praying in 1 Sam. 1:11

וַתֵּדַר נָדָר וַתֹּאמֶר יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אֱמִידָה תִּרְאֶה | בְּעֵינֵי אִמְתְּךָ וּזְכַרְתִּי וְלֹא־תִשְׁכַּח
אֶת־אִמְתְּךָ ...

The Lord prepares the prophet Jeremiah for the duty of delivering a prophecy of doom in Jer. 11:9

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֵלַי נִמְצָא־קֶשֶׁר בְּאִישׁ יְהוּדָה וּבִישָׁבֵי יְרוּשָׁלַם:

An introduction to speech most commonly ends with a contextual or a neutral form. The occasional use of a pausal form appears to mark the speech as particularly important, as in the above examples.¹⁹ Thus, it is clear that the use of a pausal form at the end of an introduction to speech is determined by conventions different from those determining the use of a pausal form within an 'ordinary' clause.

10. Pausal Forms in Typical Lists

Pausal forms terminate items, or units formed of groups of items, which make up a list, in over 100 cases. A list is here defined as a set of successive words, phrases, or clauses, which are used in parallel in that each performs the same function in the clause, or in the wider context in which they stand. Where the items composing the list are

¹⁹ Other examples are provided by the verse-initial pausal form וַיֹּאמֶר which introduces Abraham's polite invitation to the angels in Gen. 18:3, and leads to the promise that a son will be born to him. In Gen. 19:7 the same form introduces Lot's plea to his neighbours not to molest his guests, which forestalls the proposed criminal action. Both events are significant for the biblical narrative. In Gen. 19:2, the contrasting contextual form וַיֹּאמֶר, also verse-initial, introduces Lot's less hospitable invitation to the angels. This resulted in the saving of Lot and his family, an event of limited significance in the biblical story. An introduction to speech which is presented as a verse also marks the following speech as important, as in Exod. 25:1, Lev. 4:1, Num. 2:1, etc.

relatively long, each may terminate in a pausal form, as in 1 Chron. 1:8 and similar passages. Where the items composing the list are relatively short, two or three are usually grouped to form a unit which also typically terminates in a pausal form. Each such unit is occasionally treated as a verse, as in Lev. 14:54–6, Neh. 7:48–9, 55, etc., so the pausal form ending each is marked with *silluq*. More commonly, these lists formed from short items are included within a verse. In this situation, the end of each unit, and so any terminal pausal form, is typically marked with some other disjunctive accent. This provides a sharp contrast with the typical situation of a pausal form used within an ordinary clause, marked, as it is, with the accent marking the main division of the clause. An example where short items are grouped in a list occurs in Deut. 16:14:

וְשִׁמַּחְתָּ בַּחֲגֹף אֹתָהּ וּבִנְךָ וּבִתְּךָ וְעַבְדְּךָ וְאִמְתְּךָ וְהַלֹּוֹי וְהַגֵּר וְהִיתוּם וְהָאֱלֻמָּנָה
אֲשֶׁר בְּשַׁעֲרֶיךָ:

Similar examples are provided by other lists which begin with the group *אֹתָהּ וּבִנְךָ וּבִתְּךָ* (Exod. 20:10, Deut. 5:14, 12:18, 16:11). Other examples, formed from somewhat longer items, occur in Gen. 49:25, Exod. 7:28, Deut. 12:17; also 1 Sam. 22:14:

וּמִי בְּכָל־עַבְדֶּיךָ כְּדֹד נָאֻמָּן וְחֹתֵן הַמֶּלֶךְ וְסֵר אֶל־מִשְׁמַעְתְּךָ וְנִכְבֵּד בְּבֵיתְךָ:

Lists of names are often arranged so that a pausal form is used only at the main division of a verse, or at its end, and so is marked with *atnah* or *silluq* as in Gen. 10:26. This is also the case with most lists of longer items, as Deut. 28:18–19:

אֲרוּר פְּרִי־בִטְנֶךָ וּפְרִי אֲדָמָתְךָ שָׁגַר אֶלְפִיךָ וְעִשְׂתְּרוֹת צֹאֲנֶךָ: אֲרוּר אֹתָהּ בְּבֹאֲךָ
וְאֲרוּר אֹתָהּ בְּצֹאתְךָ:

also Exod. 21:24–5, Lev. 7:12, Ezra 10:28, etc. However, as most words are neutral forms, so lists, in many cases, contain only scattered pausal forms. These also are likely to be marked with *atnah* or *silluq*, as in 1 Kgs 4:8–9.

11. Pausal Forms in 'Non-Conformist' Lists

The above description covers the most obvious examples of lists. However, there are a few other lists which do not conform to the above patterns. In 1 Kgs 1:26,

וְלִי אֲנִי־עַבְדְּךָ וְלִצְדָק הַכֹּהֵן וּלְבִנְיָהוּ בֶן־יְהוֹדָע וּלְשִׁלְמָה עַבְדְּךָ לֹא קָרָא:

the first item in the list ends with a pausal form, the second and third items end with neutral forms, and the fourth and final item ends with a contextual form.²⁰ There is a similar situation in the list of three items in 1 Kgs 20:25. The final clause in Exod. 20:17 (cf. Deut. 5:21) appears to be of the same type, although the final item ends with a pausal form.

לֹא תִחַמַּד בֵּית רֶעֶךָ לֹא-תִחַמַּד אִשֶּׁת רֶעֶךָ וְעַבְדּוֹ וְאִמָּתוֹ וְשׁוֹרֹוֹ וְחִמְרֹוֹ וְכָל אֲשֶׁר
לְרֶעֶךָ:

As these examples suggest, the convention, in these 'non-conformist' lists, appears to be that the first item in the list ends with a pausal or neutral form. This form is typically (cf. n. 20) marked with an accent which marks the main division of a unit comprising the complete list, or the initial section of it (semantically defined).²¹ This first item is also typically the most important in the list, and can sometimes be considered as comprehending all items listed (as in Deut. 30:9). Items following the first in the list, including the last, may end with a neutral, pausal or contextual form. This convention appears to be followed in the lists named above, and also in Gen. 17:12, Deut. 8:7, 9:1, 11:14, 30:9, Isa. 28:2, and also 2 Kgs 19:13, assuming that the last two words in the verse are not part of the list of kings. This description also applies to the list in Deut. 6:7 and 11:19, where the first item ends with the pausal form בְּבִיתְךָ. The two following items end with contextual forms, but the fourth and last item is the pausal form, וּבְקִוְמָךְ. The accents present items in these lists in two contrasting pairs, and so present the list in a conventional form, contrasting with the vowelling (see §14). There is a similar case in Deut. 30:9, although there the list does not end with a pausal form.

12. Pause in the Three 'Poetical' Books

The general description of the use of pausal forms in the Twenty-one Books, and so these conclusions, is also valid for their use in the

²⁰ This is marked with *tifḥa*, which marks the main division of the clause, so that the accentuation is not consistent with the vowelling. The initial pausal form, marked with the accent *teḥiṣa*, may mark what was originally the main division. I doubt if Ben-David (1995: §0.1.1, 5–6) is right in suggesting that וְלִי אֲנִי עַבְדְּךָ is to be considered a separate clause. It is simply an item in a list, similar to אֶתָּה וּבְנֵי-יִבְרָתְךָ (Exod. 20:10), which is also an item in a list ending in a pausal form marked with *teḥiṣa*.

²¹ E.g., in Exod. 20:17, Deut. 5:21, the accent *revia* marks the main division of the section of the list ending וְחִמְרֹוֹ. This section covers individual items; the concluding section is general and comprehensive.

Three 'Poetical' books: Psalms, Job, Proverbs. However, the Three Books are composed in relatively short clauses, which provide, at their ends, more frequent opportunity for the use of pausal forms than do the longer clauses of the Twenty-one Books. On the other hand, the use of pausal forms within clauses in the Three Books is correspondingly reduced.²² Less than one in ten of the more than 2,250 pausal forms in the Three Books is used within a clause. The use of pausal forms within clauses in the poetical books follows the same general pattern as it does in the prose books, but clause structure in the poetical books is more varied, so that the description of the positions in which pausal forms are used within clauses in the prose books would need to be considerably expanded to cover their use in the poetical books adequately. However, the notable fact that a pausal form within a clause typically stands at the main division of the clause is equally valid in both, as is shown for the Three Books by the common examples where a pausal form within a clause is marked with the accent marking the main division of the verse: '*Oleh weyored*, as in Ps. 56:14, Job 32:6 etc., or *atnah*, as in Ps. 2:2, Job 4:6, Prov. 1:17 etc., or even *revia* (*mugraš*) as in Ps. 128:4:

הנה כִּי־כֵן יִבְרַךְ גִּבּוֹר יִרְא יְהוָה:

Also Job 33:24. If *atnah* does not stand at the main division of a verse, it may, even so, mark a pausal form at the main division of a clause, as in Ps. 22:15:

כִּמִּים נִשְׁפָּכְתִּי וְהִתְפַּרְדִּי כָּל־עֲצָמוֹתַי הִיָּה לִבִּי כְּדוֹגֵג נָמַס בְּתוֹךְ מַעַי:

Other accents, of course, may also mark the main division of a clause, as *sinnor* in Job 7:20:

חֲטָאתִי מֶה אֲפַעַל | לִךְ נֹצֵר הָאָדָם

Also Ps. 79:13. *Dehi* can also be used in this way, as in Ps. 45:2, 66:15.

Occasionally, a pausal form is marked with a conjunctive accent. In the Three Books, this seems mainly due to carelessness.²³ In any

²² This tendency is also visible in the latter prophets, where the 200 cases of pause within a clause form a much smaller proportion of the total pausal forms (about 10% of over 2,000) than do those in the Torah (329 of 1850, about 17%) and Former Prophets (183 of 1250 about 13%), or those in the prose writings (220 of 739, about 29%).

²³ As with *למשפטך* (with *munah* Ps. 119:43), *כמשפטך* (with *merka*, Ps. 119:149), probably due to the defective writing of a plural noun. In Ps. 93:1, the pointing of *לבש* (with *munah*) may be influenced by the preceding *לבש* (with '*Oleh weyored*'), which ends a clause. In Prov. 25:3 *וארץ* (with *munah*), though separated by one

case, these forms, if correctly identified as pausal, most probably only reflect the fact that, when the accentuation was fixed in the text, pausal forms had come to be regarded as undetermined variations of the contextual form (see n. 29 below).

13. Pause Marking Several Divisions in a Clause

In the discussion of the material in the Twenty-one Books, it was suggested that all pausal forms within ordinary clauses stand at the main division of the clause, but this is not entirely correct. A small proportion of them mark other divisions. For example, in Ezek. 44:5, the pausal form **שָׁמַע** is marked with *revia*, which marks it as the main divider of the core of the clause (free of the terminal prepositional phrases), which ends with the pausal form **אֶתְךָ**, marked with *zaqef*. This word marks the main division of the complete clause, which extends to **תּוֹרָתוֹ**, marked with *atnah*. Thus the pausal forms divide this clause into three parts. The same is true in 2 Sam. 24:13, in a clause composed of a verb and a prepositional modifier, followed by three nominal phrases presenting alternative questions, each of which ends with a pausal form. The first of these forms, **בְּאַרְצֶךָ**, is marked with *pazer*, which marks it as the main divider of the unit ending with the second pausal form, **רִדְפְּךָ**. This word is marked with *revia*, which shows it to be the main divider of the unit ending with the third pausal form, again **בְּאַרְצֶךָ**, which is marked with *zaqef*, and ends the clause. However, most words do not appear in contrasting pausal and contextual forms. In several cases a pausal form which does not stand at the main division of a clause can be assumed to show that that clause was divided into more than two sections. For example, **רָכַשׁ** (Gen. 31:18) is marked with *zaqef*, as the main divider of the unit ending **אֶרֶם** marked with *atnah*, whereas the clause ends with **כְּנָעַן** marked with *silluq*. Presumably the clause was also divided at **אֶרֶם**, although that word, being a neutral form, could not mark the division. Similar cases occur in Gen. 17:7 **וּבִינֶךָ**, and in Jer. 22:25 **נִפְשֶׁךָ**, which both mark the main division of the *atnah* unit, in a clause which continues for the whole verse. There is some reason to suppose

word from the preceding **שָׁמַע** may have been influenced by the common pair **וְאֶרֶץ**. In this case, and the similar one in Isa. 65:17, the word is marked with a conjunctive accent, which is unusual. A word with prefixed *waw* with *qames* is typically marked with a disjunctive accent, as is the even more surprising use of **וְאֶרֶץ** in Isa. 26:19. These three cases can only be treated as anomalies, as was already recognized by the Masoretes.

that, occasionally, a clause may have been divided into more than three parts. In Dan. 9:24, קִדְשָׁךְ, marked with *revia*, marks the main division of the unit ending עֵינֶיךָ, which is marked with *zaqef*. If pause was used at this *zaqef*, and also at the following *atnah*, the clause would have been divided into four parts. Pausal forms do not, however, always suggest neat divisions of a verse. In Deut. 30:9, יִדְּךָ, marked with *revia*, should mark the main division of the unit ending אֶדְמָתְךָ which is marked with *tifha*; however the clause ends with the following word, which is marked with *atnah*. There is a similar case in 2 Kgs 20:17 (see §8) and in Isa. 39:6. This phenomenon of subdivision of semantic units is not restricted to clauses. The introduction to speech in Isa. 44:24 ends with the pausal form מִבְּטֶן but the unit is divided internally by the pausal form גִּּאֲלֶךָ. There is a similar case in Ezek. 44:6, where the ISP ends with the neutral form יִשְׂרָאֵל but is divided by the pausal form מִרִּי. Similarly, the initial constituent of a clause is occasionally divided by a pausal form, as in Lev. 18:9. These cases support the conclusion that, as in verses, in long or complex semantic units, most of which are clauses, divisions are marked by pausal forms not only at the main division in the unit, but also in other positions rendered suitable by the semantic structure of the passage.

14. Vowels and Accents Representing Different Understandings of a Verse

A small number of pausal forms which are not marked with the accent marking the main division of a clause, appear to represent cases in which vowelling and accentuation reflect different understandings of the passage.²⁴ For example, the two cases in which a conjunctive accent is marked on a pausal form terminating a protasis in Mal. 1:6

וְאִם־אֵב אֲנִי אֵיהָ כְּבוֹדִי וְאִם־אֲדוֹנִים אֲנִי אֵיהָ מוֹרָאִי

The vowelling here presumably reflects a tradition in which each of the two protases was treated as an independent clause which was followed by an apodosis.²⁵ The structure of the passage as composed of

²⁴ An example has been given above in n. 20 to §11. This phenomenon is not restricted to pausal forms, but is also reflected in other situations in which the accents are not consistent with the vowelling. See n. 9 to §3.

²⁵ A protasis is terminated by a pausal form in some 50 other cases, as Gen. 31:52, Exod. 7:27, Lev. 2:7, Num. 14:28, Deut. 20:12, etc. For Ben-David, the vowelling of אֲנִי in Mal. 1:6 is due to the preceding predicate (1995: 88, §5), whereas אִם־אֲדוֹנִים

two conditional sentences was thus highlighted, emphasizing the question of whether the speaker is, in fact, a 'father' or a 'Lord'. The accentuation reflects a tradition in which the two conditional sentences were each treated as an undivided unit. This highlights the value of the passage as presenting two questions, emphasizing the problem of whether the speaker was in fact treated as 'father' or 'Lord'. This change accounts for the use of a conjunctive accent to mark the pausal forms.²⁶ Such treatment implies that pausal and contextual forms were treated as unconditioned variants (see n. 29 below). Change in the understanding of the passage also appears to have occurred in the list in Deut. 6:7 and 11:19. This has been treated as an example of a 'non-conformist' style of list in §11 above, as suggested by the vowelling. In contrast, the accentuation presents it as a typical list of short items grouped in pairs, so that **בְּיָתֶךָ**, which is marked with *pašta*, is expected to show a contextual form, and **בְּדֶרֶךְךָ**, marked with *zaqef*, to which the *pašta* is subordinate, is expected to show a pausal form (as noted in Ben-David 1995: §0.0.0, 1). A similar inconsistency appears to occur in Deut. 18:4, where **צִאֲנֶךָ**, marked with *tifha*, which marks the main division of the verse and the clause in terms of the accents, is a contextual form, while the preceding **וַיִּצְהָרְךָ**, marked with *revia* subordinate to the *tifha*, is pausal in form. It seems quite probable that **וַיִּצְהָרְךָ**, rather than **צִאֲנֶךָ**, marked the main division of the verse when the vowelling was fixed.²⁷ Another similar case occurs in Deut. 15:11, where the pausal form **לְעִנִּיךָ** is marked with *tevir*, whereas the following **וְלֹאֲבִינֶךָ**, marked with *tifha*, to which the *tevir* is subordinate, is contextual in form. Possibly, **לְעִנִּיךָ** was considered the main division of the clause when the vowelling was fixed.²⁸ In Exod. 10:4, the marking of *munah* on the pausal form **לְשִׁלַּח** has been explained by Ben-David as due to

and **וְאִם־אֵתָהּ** (showing 'minor' pause) in Gen. 31:52 are incomplete clauses (ibid. p. 105, n. 224).

²⁶ Other examples of pausal forms marked with conjunctive accents are discussed in Revell 2011.

²⁷ So Breuer 1992: 225. Geiger 2005: 103 suggests that the pointing in this case was not conditioned by the accents, but was influenced by the four other uses of the same words (Deut. 7:13, 11:14, 12:17, 14:23). Ben-David 1995: 74, n. 126, points out that **וַיִּצְהָרְךָ**, in contextual form, does not occur. It should, however, be noted, that, in all five cases, the pausal form of this word stands at the end of a unit in a list, where pause is to be expected.

²⁸ Ben-David argues (1995: §1.5.1.1, 67) that **לְעִנִּיךָ** is, itself, contextual in form. However, the understanding of this form as pausal is compatible with the structure of the feminine form **עֲנִיָּה** (Isa. 54:11, etc.), so it seems unlikely that Ben-David is correct.

an addition to the text made after the vowing had been fixed.²⁹ Another possibility is that it derives from a form of tradition in which it (rather than the contextual form אָתָּה as marked by the accents) stood at the main division of the clause. A similar case occurs in שָׁפַט אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל (1 Sam. 7:17). The pausal form of שָׁפַט may reflect a tradition in which this word, and not the preceding adverb שָׁם, stood at the main division of the clause.³⁰ These cases would then each provide a typical example of a pausal form, marked by the accent marking the main division of the clause, standing before the final constituent of the clause. In Deut. 4:26 the apparently pausal form תִּאֲבָדוּן might possibly show that the clause was divided into more than two sections. I can suggest no explanation for the use of the similar form יִשְׁאָלוּן in Jos. 4:6 and 4:21.

15. Pausal Forms in Clauses and Verses

It seems clear that the use of a pausal form within an ordinary clause is related to the use of such a form within a verse. Indeed, the two are often identical, as in Gen. 11:1, Deut. 6:9, 1 Chron. 29:26, etc. The pausal form typically marks the main division in the clause, just as it usually does in a verse. The pausal form marking the main division of an ordinary clause may be marked with a variety of accents, but most commonly a strong accent is used: *atnah*, *zaqef*, or *tifha*, accents which also mark a pausal form at the main division of a verse. However, a pausal form marking the main division of a clause may be marked with some other disjunctive accent. This makes it clear that the occurrence of a pausal form is not determined by the individual accent marked on it, but by its position in the language of the text. It is determined by the fact that it ends, or marks the main division of, a significant semantic or syntactic unit. A word does not appear in pausal form because it is marked by *atnah* or

²⁹ Ben-David 1995: §2.3.1.6.2, n. 24 (p. 132) suggests that the words אֶת־עַמִּי were added to wording copied, complete with vowing, from Exod. 7:27, 9:2. This addition necessitated a change in the accentuation. As a result, the (accentual) word אֶת־עַמִּי is marked with *atnah*, and the preceding pausal form לְשִׁלֹּחַ with a conjunctive. This would imply that the significance of the pausal form was not recognized; it was regarded as simply a chance variant of the contextual form.

³⁰ Ben-David 1995: §2.4.1.3 (p.138) suggests that the pausal vowing of שָׁפַט was introduced to avoid cacophony, citing the note to G.K. §29i in support. That note, however, ignores the fact that the words שָׁפַט אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל, with the same verb in contextual form and with a conjunctive accent, occur in Judg. 16:31 and 1 Sam. 4:18.

silluq, but because it stands at the main division of a verse, or at its end. The same is true of any other accent with pausal forms in other positions. These pausal forms stand at the end of a clause, or at its main division, or occasionally at some other significant break within a clause (as described in §13). The accents with which they are marked are chosen according to the conventions of the accent system, based on the understanding of the passage at the time of their introduction. It can be argued that where a pausal form ends an ISP, or is used to mark one of two or more divisions in a clause, the pausal form can still be seen as marking the main division of a semantic unit, as shown in §13. That unit may not be a clause in terms of syntax, but this is also true of many verses. This suggests that the divisions marked by pausal forms also mark a form of 'dichotomy', imperfect though it might be, in much the same way as do the accents. That is, pausal forms have no relationship with the individual accents marked in the biblical text, but they do, in fact, mark basic structures in the same or a similar way as does the accentuation.

16. All Pausal Forms are Equally Significant

This survey has shown that the system of pausal forms is not simply a matter of their significant regular use when marked with strong accents, such as *silluq* and *atnah*, and their occasional, relatively unimportant, use elsewhere. In fact, pausal forms are used in a regular way, at the main division of a semantic unit, and at its end, in almost all cases. Thus, a pausal form is used at the end of a clause, unless that clause forms a semantic unit with one or more other clauses. It may also be used at the main division of a clause, and occasionally elsewhere within it. The use of pausal forms within clauses is sporadic in that it fails to occur in many clauses, but is regular in that (with rare exceptions), the pausal form is used at the main division of the clause, or to end some other significant semantic unit. It may not be obvious why a pausal form is used at the main division of one clause but not that of another, but this is also true of the use of pausal forms at the main division of a verse which does not use *atnah*,³¹ and, indeed, why the main division of one verse is marked with *tifha* and that of another

³¹ Most accents marking the main division of a verse in which *atnah* is not used are marked on neutral forms. The few pausal and contextual forms marked with *tifha* or *zaqef* where one of these is the main divider of the verse are listed in Geiger 2005: §3.2–3, 99–104.

with *atnah*.³² I assume that such questions could be answered only after a comprehensive study of the basis of the division of the text into verses, and into smaller units within the verses. The above discussion has shown quite clearly that the occurrence of pausal forms in a passage is determined by syntactic and semantic units of which the passage is composed. The relation of these forms to the accents is determined simply by the choice of accents used to delimit these units.

17. Conclusion

This survey can, then, conclude that the occurrence of pausal forms is not determined by the accents which mark them, but by the syntactic, or, more properly, the semantic structure of the text. Most pausal forms stand at the end of a clause. A proportion stand at the main division, or, occasionally, also at subsidiary divisions of a clause. These positions account not only for the greater number of pausal forms, which are marked with *sillug* and *atnah*, but also for the others, no less important, which may be marked with any other disjunctive accent. Pausal forms, then, mark the end and the middle of clauses in much the same way as they do the ends and middle of verses, and so can be said to mark the so-called dichotomy much as do the accents. This suggests that the tendency to mark 'dichotomy' was a feature of the Hebrew language, not simply of the biblical chant. It also suggests that the vowelling, or, some features of it, was fixed in the text before the accentuation. This is not to suggest that minor details of either system, such as conjunctive accents, and composite or simple *shewas*, were all fixed in place at this time, but simply that pausal forms delimiting the basic units of the text were fixed in place before the accentuation was introduced. It seems most likely that, although the pausal forms were preserved in the traditional vowelling when the accents were introduced, they were regarded, by that time, simply as free variants of the contextual forms. This is shown by the marking of some forms with conjunctive accents, or other accents inconsistent with the pausal vowelling (see §14 and n. 29). If the accentuation was in place first, and conditioned the vowelling, as is commonly supposed, the vowelling should be consistent with the accentuation. This is often not the case (see §3 and n. 9). It does not seem possible that such inconsistency should have occurred if the vowelling were fixed

³² See Geiger 2005: 99. Wickes describes the choice, in certain cases, as 'entirely optional' (1887: 63).

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after the accentuation was in place, and determined the presentation of the text.

Address for Correspondence: ejrevell@eastlink.ca
48 Whidden Street, Antigonish NS, Canada B2G 2Z2

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